

COMSATS University, Islamabad Pakistan

FalconScan

(AI-powered APK Vulnerability Scanner)

By

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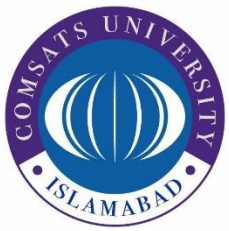
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Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security (2022-2026)

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COMSATS University, Islamabad Pakistan

FalconScan

(AI-powered APK Vulnerability Scanner)

A project presented to

COMSATS University, Islamabad

In partial fulfillment

of the requirement for the degree of

Bachelor of Science in Cyber Security (2022-2026)

By

Mohamed Ahsan **CIIT/FA22-BCT-001/ISB**

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Mohamed Ahsan **Abdullah**

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CERTIFICATE OF APPROVAL

It is to certify that the final year project of BS (CT) FalconScan was developed by **Mohamed Ahsan (CIIT/FA22-BCT-001)** and **Abdullah (CIIT/FA22-BCT-004)** under the supervision of Dr. Farhana Jabeen and that in her opinion; it is fully adequate, in scope and quality for the degree of Bachelors of Science in Cyber Security.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

With the rapid expansion of Android applications across industries, ensuring mobile app security has become a major challenge. Traditional vulnerability detection tools, such as MobSF and VirusTotal, primarily rely on static rule-based analysis, which is limited to identifying known threats. These approaches struggle to detect advanced or obfuscated vulnerabilities that exhibit malicious behavior only during runtime. Moreover, the manual interpretation of scan results consumes time and requires expert knowledge, making large-scale security testing inefficient.

To overcome these limitations, FalconScan has been developed, an AI-powered APK Vulnerability Scanner designed to automate the detection of both known and unknown security threats in Android applications. FalconScan integrates static and dynamic analysis techniques within a unified hybrid framework, providing comprehensive insights into app security.

The system performs static analysis by decompiling APKs and examining manifest files, permissions, and API usage, while its dynamic analysis engine executes the application in a controlled emulator environment to observe runtime behavior such as network communication, file access, and system calls. Extracted features from both phases are then analyzed using a Large Language Model (LLM), which intelligently classifies vulnerabilities and provides human-readable explanations for its decisions.

FalconScan operates through a web-based interface, allowing users to upload APKs, initiate scans, and view detailed vulnerability reports with severity levels and mitigation recommendations. The platform also maintains a local vulnerability database for quick rule-based detection and supports continuous learning through periodic AI model updates, ensuring adaptability to emerging threats.

By automating complex analysis workflows and incorporating AI reasoning, FalconScan significantly reduces manual effort, increases detection accuracy, and provides actionable insights for developers and cybersecurity professionals. It serves as an innovative, research-oriented, and scalable solution for modern Android application security assessment.

Abstract

The proposed project, FalconScan, is developed to create an intelligent and automated solution for detecting vulnerabilities in Android applications using AI-driven hybrid analysis. Existing systems such as MobSF and VirusTotal primarily rely on static rule-based checks and limited dynamic tracing, which fail to detect complex or obfuscated threats effectively. These traditional tools require significant manual interpretation and lack intelligent behavior analysis capabilities. The main challenge lies in identifying hidden or runtime-based vulnerabilities and reducing the dependence on fragmented tools and manual effort during mobile app security assessment. Current systems also lack adaptive learning and comprehensive behavioral insight, leaving a gap in detecting unknown or zero-day threats. FalconScan aims to integrate static and dynamic analysis techniques with Large Language Model (LLM)-based reasoning to intelligently classify vulnerabilities, generate explainable reports, and support continuous AI model improvement. It will automate the scanning workflow, monitor runtime app behavior in an emulator, and provide detailed vulnerability reports through a web interface. The project also seeks to improve detection accuracy and scalability while minimizing manual intervention. Ultimately, FalconScan will offer a powerful, efficient, and intelligent solution that enhances mobile application security and assists developers and analysts in mitigating Android threats effectively.

Acknowledgement

All praise is to Almighty Allah who bestowed upon us a minute portion of His boundless knowledge by virtue of which we were able to accomplish this challenging task.

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Mohamed Ahsan Abdullah

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Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form
AI	Artificial Intelligence
API	Application Programming Interface
APK	Android Package Kit
AVD	Android Virtual Device
CI	Continuous Integration
CIIT	COMSATS Institute of Information Technology
CPU	Central Processing Unit
CVSS	Common Vulnerability Scoring System
DB	Database
DFA	Dynamic Fuzzing Analysis
DL	Deep Learning
FR	Functional Requirement
GPU	Graphics Processing Unit
GUI	Graphical User Interface
HTTPS	Hypertext Transfer Protocol Secure
ISB	Islamabad Campus
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
LLM	Large Language Model
MCP	Model Context Protocol
ML	Machine Learning
MobSF	Mobile Security Framework
NLP	Natural Language Processing
NFR	Non-Functional Requirement
OS	Operating System
PDF	Portable Document Format
PER	Performance Requirement
REL	Reliability Requirement

RQ	Requirement
SRS	Software Requirements Specification
SQL	Structured Query Language
TLS	Transport Layer Security
UI	User Interface
UML	Unified Modeling Language
USE	Usability Requirement
VM	Virtual Machine
VMS	Vulnerability Management System
VTS	VirusTotal Scanner
XML	Extensible Markup Language

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1 Chapter 1: Introduction and Problem Definition

This chapter presents a comprehensive overview of the proposed FalconScan project, highlighting the background, motivations, technical foundations, objectives, and the scope of the system. It introduces the problem domain of Android application security, describes the limitations of current solutions, and positions FalconScan as an innovative platform that bridges gaps in mobile cybersecurity. Furthermore, the chapter outlines the modular architecture, technological choices, and expected contributions to the field of mobile application security, demonstrating alignment with academic and practical requirements.

1.1 Overview of the Project

FalconScan is an AI-powered, full-stack Android APK vulnerability scanner designed to automatically identify and report security weaknesses in mobile applications. It combines a hybrid analysis framework—leveraging static code examination, dynamic runtime observation, and AI-based reasoning—to provide a comprehensive understanding of potential vulnerabilities. The system is built as a web-based platform with a Next.js 16 frontend interfacing with a Django 4.2 REST API backend, enabling users to upload APK files, initiate analyses, and receive detailed vulnerability reports in a seamless, automated workflow.

The proliferation of Android applications across industries such as finance, healthcare, e-commerce, and education has made them a prime target for cyber attacks. Despite the widespread use of Android devices, the ecosystem's openness introduces significant security risks, including malware injection, data exfiltration, privilege escalation, and unauthorized access to sensitive resources. Traditional security scanners like MobSF and VirusTotal primarily rely on static, signature-based analyses that are limited to known vulnerabilities. These tools struggle to detect complex, obfuscated, or zero-day threats that may arise only during runtime execution.

FalconScan addresses these limitations by integrating static and dynamic analyses with artificial intelligence for contextual reasoning. During static analysis, the platform inspects the APK structure, metadata, permission declarations, and API call patterns. The dynamic engine then executes the application in a sandboxed environment to monitor runtime behaviors such as

network interactions, file operations, inter-process communication, and system calls. The system aggregates these observations and applies LLM-based reasoning to generate human-readable vulnerability explanations, complete with risk assessments and actionable remediation guidance.

By automating the detection and reporting process, FalconScan significantly reduces reliance on manual intervention, improves accuracy in identifying both known and unknown threats, and equips developers, QA teams, and security analysts with actionable insights. This makes the platform a valuable contribution to mobile cybersecurity, offering a more intelligent, user-friendly, and reliable alternative to conventional tools.

1.2 Vision Statement

FalconScan is envisioned as a next-generation security solution for Android developers, cybersecurity researchers, and organizations seeking to enhance mobile application reliability and protect sensitive user data. As Android applications face growing risks from malicious code, insecure data handling, and inefficient manual vulnerability assessment, FalconScan provides an AI-driven, automated, and comprehensive scanning system.

The platform stands out by combining hybrid analysis techniques with machine learning and natural language reasoning. Unlike conventional static analyzers that depend solely on predefined signatures and heuristics, FalconScan uses intelligent models to identify both known and previously unseen vulnerabilities. The system not only detects threats but also classifies them by severity, explains their technical implications in accessible language, and suggests remediation strategies. Through this approach, FalconScan enables developers and security teams to proactively mitigate risks, streamline vulnerability management, and maintain a higher standard of mobile application security.

1.3 Problem Statement

The security of Android applications continues to be a pressing concern due to the open-source nature of the platform, the sheer volume of applications distributed across official and unofficial marketplaces, and the diverse skill levels of developers. Existing static analysis tools are often

inadequate for detecting dynamic threats or obfuscated code, and manual vulnerability testing demands expert knowledge and extensive effort. As a result, many applications are released with latent security flaws that can be exploited by malicious actors.

Furthermore, static analysis alone is insufficient to detect vulnerabilities that manifest only during runtime, such as dynamic code loading, network-based attacks, or sophisticated evasion techniques. Although dynamic analysis tools exist, they are resource-intensive, slow, and frequently produce unstructured outputs that are difficult to interpret without advanced expertise. Consequently, there is an increasing demand for an integrated platform that automates vulnerability detection, simplifies interpretation of findings, and bridges the gap between static, dynamic, and intelligent reasoning approaches.

1.4 Problem Solution

FalconScan provides a solution by combining hybrid analysis techniques with AI-enhanced reasoning. The system performs comprehensive static analysis, including decompilation, metadata extraction, permission mapping, API pattern analysis, and preliminary security checks. It then executes the APK in a controlled dynamic environment to observe actual runtime behavior, capturing anomalies in file access, network communication, inter-component interactions, and system call sequences.

The integration of a Large Language Model (LLM) enables FalconScan to generate detailed, human-readable explanations of identified vulnerabilities, translating complex technical findings into actionable insights. The platform categorizes vulnerabilities by severity, logs evidence for auditing and compliance, and provides concrete recommendations for remediation. By offering automated scanning, contextual analysis, and clear reporting, FalconScan reduces manual effort, improves detection rates, and empowers developers and security analysts to address security flaws effectively.

Ultimately, FalconScan contributes to a safer Android ecosystem by facilitating early vulnerability detection, enhancing the reliability of mobile applications, and providing an intelligent, adaptive, and user-centric approach to mobile security. Its hybrid, AI-driven

methodology represents a significant advancement over traditional tools, ensuring that developers and organizations can proactively mitigate security risks in their Android applications throughout the software development lifecycle.

1.5 Objectives of the Proposed System

BO-1: Develop a hybrid static and dynamic analysis framework capable of detecting both known and unknown vulnerabilities in Android APKs.

BO-2: Integrate AI/LLM-based reasoning to classify vulnerabilities, provide detailed explanations, and suggest remediation actions for developers and security analysts.

BO-3: Automate the entire APK vulnerability scanning process through an intuitive web interface to minimize manual effort and human error.

BO-4: Maintain a local vulnerability knowledge base to enable rapid detection of common threats and continuous learning from new scans.

BO-5: Enable dynamic runtime monitoring using an Android emulator or sandbox to detect behavioral anomalies and runtime-specific threats.

BO-6: Generate comprehensive, human-readable security reports with severity classifications, evidence, and remediation guidance.

BO-7: Implement a dedicated static fuzzing module that automatically generates and tests malformed or boundary-case inputs, identifying potential vulnerabilities in APK components prior to runtime execution.

1.6 Scope

The scope of FalconScan encompasses the complete lifecycle of Android APK security assessment, from secure file submission to comprehensive report generation. Users can upload APKs via a web interface, which automatically triggers modular analysis pipelines. The system's

static analysis engine inspects decompiled code, manifest configurations, permission structures, and embedded components, while the dedicated static fuzzing module generates and tests mutated inputs to detect potential vulnerabilities before runtime.

The dynamic analysis engine executes APKs within a controlled Android emulator to capture runtime behaviors, including network requests, file system access, inter-process communication, and system calls. Extracted features from both static, fuzzing, and dynamic modules are processed by a hybrid AI engine that combines machine learning classification and LLM-based reasoning to produce structured vulnerability reports. Reports include categories such as insecure API calls, privilege escalation, sensitive data leaks, and runtime misbehavior, along with severity ratings, textual explanations, and suggested mitigations.

FalconScan is designed as a modular and extensible platform, allowing the integration of additional scanning engines, threat models, or AI capabilities in the future. The platform supports multiple concurrent analyses, secure file handling, and role-based access control for administrators and users. Performance optimization, scalability, and usability are key focus areas, ensuring effective handling of large and complex APKs. The system targets Android developers, QA testers, cybersecurity analysts, and academic researchers in mobile security domains.

1.6.1 Limitations/Constraints

LI-1: FalconScan supports only Android APK files; iOS, hybrid, or other mobile application formats are not covered.

LI-2: Dynamic analysis is limited to virtualized Android emulators; real device testing is not included.

LI-3: LLM-based reasoning may occasionally produce incomplete or imprecise vulnerability explanations due to training data limitations.

LI-4: Certain AI-assisted processing and external vulnerability database updates require internet connectivity.

LI-5: Static fuzzing focuses on pre-runtime vulnerability detection but may not identify all runtime-specific edge cases.

LI-6: The system is primarily intended for research, educational, or proof-of-concept use; commercial-grade deployment may require additional enhancements in scalability, performance, and security hardening.

LI-7: Advanced malware reverse engineering, obfuscation removal, and integration with real-time threat intelligence feeds are out of scope for the current version but are planned for future updates.

1.7 Modules

1.7.1 Module 1: User Authentication & APK Management

- **FE-1:** User registration and login via Next.js frontend, backed by Django SimpleJWT auth.
- **FE-2:** Role-based access control (Admin, User, Guest).
- **FE-3:** Upload APKs via web interface, supporting drag-and-drop and multiple files.
- **FE-4:** Validate APK integrity (hash, format) before processing.
- **FE-5:** Store APK metadata (name, size, hash, developer info, timestamps) in Django models.
- **FE-6:** Allow users to delete, archive, or tag APKs.
- **FE-7:** Trigger static and dynamic analysis pipelines automatically upon upload.
- **FE-8:** Notify users of analysis completion via dashboard or toast notifications.

1.7.2 Module 2: Static Analysis Engine

- **FE-1:** Decompile APK using Androguard and JADX.
- **FE-2:** Analyze AndroidManifest.xml for exported components, permission misuse, and intent filters.
- **FE-3:** Detect hardcoded secrets, cryptography misuse, and insecure configurations.

- **FE-4:** Extract static features (permissions, intents, API usage) for AI input.
- **FE-5:** Store static analysis reports and feature vectors for further processing.
- **FE-6:** Provide API endpoint for frontend to retrieve static analysis results.
- **FE-7:** Support rescan functionality for updated APKs.
- **FE-8:** Maintain audit logs of static analysis operations.

1.7.3 Module 3: Static Fuzzing Engine

- **FE 1:** Identify fuzzable targets in decompiled code (methods, intents, input handlers).
- **FE 2:** Generate mutated static inputs for method parameters, intents, and data flows.
- **FE 3:** Perform static fuzz simulation on CFG/DFG without executing the APK.
- **FE 4:** Detect potential crash points, unsafe parsing, and vulnerable data paths.
- **FE 5:** Extract fuzzing derived static features for AI based vulnerability classification.
- **FE 6:** Provide API endpoint for frontend to visualize static fuzzing results.
- **FE 7:** Support batch static fuzzing for multiple APKs in queue.
- **FE 8:** Store static fuzzing logs, mutation sets, and detected paths for audit and retraining.

1.7.4 Module 4: Dynamic Analysis Engine

- **FE-1:** Launch APKs in a sandboxed Android emulator.
- **FE-2:** Monitor file system, network, and IPC activity.
- **FE-3:** Capture system calls, runtime exceptions, and crashes.
- **FE-4:** Simulate user interactions automatically.
- **FE-5:** Detect suspicious runtime behaviors.
- **FE-6:** Extract dynamic feature vectors for AI model input.
- **FE-7:** Provide dynamic analysis logs and summaries for reporting.
- **FE-8:** Store raw dynamic logs for retraining and audit.

1.7.5 Module 5: LLM-Driven Vulnerability Analysis

- **FE-1:** Preprocess static, fuzzing, and dynamic features for AI input.

- **FE-2:** Classify APKs as benign or malicious using trained LLM.
- **FE-3:** Assign severity scores and confidence levels.
- **FE-4:** Generate natural-language explanations and remediation suggestions.
- **FE-5:** Update AI model periodically with new data.
- **FE-6:** Identify false positives and feed them back for model retraining.
- **FE-7:** Correlate static, fuzzing, and dynamic findings for accuracy.
- **FE-8:** Prioritize vulnerabilities based on risk context.
- **FE-9:** Provide API endpoints for frontend visualization of AI reasoning.

1.7.6 Module 6: Reporting & Dashboard UI

- **FE-1:** Next.js/React dashboard displaying APK scan status, history, and statistics.
- **FE-2:** Visualize static, fuzzing, dynamic, and AI analysis results.
- **FE-3:** Export PDF/JSON/CSV reports via Django backend (ReportLab/PyPDF2).
- **FE-4:** Interactive charts (Recharts) and graphs for risk visualization.
- **FE-5:** Display AI reasoning and remediation suggestions alongside vulnerabilities.
- **FE-6:** Toast notifications via Sonner for scan completion or errors.
- **FE-7:** Role-based access control for sensitive actions (delete scan, retrain AI).
- **FE-8:** Filter, sort, and search scan reports dynamically.
- **FE-9:** Mobile-responsive and themeable UI using Tailwind CSS and Vaul theming.

1.8 Related System Analysis/Literature Review

1.8.1 Literature Review

Recent research in Android application security underscores the critical need for comprehensive vulnerability detection that combines both static and dynamic analysis techniques. Static analysis, which examines the code, manifest files, and permission structures without executing the application, is effective for identifying known patterns, insecure API usage, and misconfigurations. However, studies by Faruki et al. (2022) and Wei et al. (2023) have shown that static approaches alone cannot detect vulnerabilities that manifest only during runtime, such

as dynamic code loading, network misuse, or obfuscated malicious behaviors. On the other hand, dynamic analysis—executing applications in controlled environments to observe their runtime behavior—provides insight into actual execution paths, resource usage, and inter-component communication, but it faces challenges in terms of computational overhead, scalability, and handling large or complex APKs.

To overcome these limitations, recent works have explored hybrid analysis frameworks that integrate static and dynamic methods. Hybrid systems can detect a broader range of vulnerabilities by leveraging the strengths of both approaches. For instance, frameworks like MobSF have been widely adopted in research and industry for automated APK analysis, but they primarily rely on rule-based detection methods. These methods are effective against known vulnerabilities but struggle with zero-day threats, obfuscated code, or sophisticated malware variants.

In addition, machine learning and deep learning techniques have gained traction for enhancing detection accuracy. Researchers have employed feature extraction from APKs, permission analysis, API call patterns, and behavioral modeling to train classifiers capable of distinguishing malicious from benign applications. While these approaches improve automation and detection efficiency, they often lack interpretability; they can flag vulnerabilities but fail to explain their origin, impact, or remediation measures in a comprehensible manner. This interpretability gap is a significant challenge, especially for developers and security analysts who require actionable guidance rather than binary verdicts.

Recently, Large Language Models (LLMs) such as GPT and BERT have been explored for their ability to reason about code and natural language. These models can summarize code behavior, analyze potential security risks, and generate human-readable explanations of vulnerabilities, bridging the interpretability gap left by traditional machine learning or rule-based systems. Studies have shown that LLMs can provide context-aware insights, suggest mitigation strategies, and even detect nuanced vulnerabilities that purely automated static or dynamic methods might miss.

FalconScan builds upon this body of research by integrating hybrid static-dynamic analysis with LLM-based reasoning, creating an intelligent and interpretable APK vulnerability scanner. By combining traditional vulnerability detection methods with AI-driven explanations, FalconScan addresses the key limitations of prior systems: it can detect both known and unknown threats, handle runtime behaviors, and provide clear, actionable guidance for developers, researchers, and QA teams. Furthermore, the inclusion of static fuzzing techniques adds an additional layer of pre-runtime vulnerability discovery, enabling the identification of edge-case input vulnerabilities that may not appear during normal execution.

1.8.2 Related System Analysis

Table 1.1: Related System Analysis with proposed project solution

Application Name	Weakness	Proposed Project Solution
MobSF (Mobile Security Framework)	Limited to rule-based static/dynamic analysis; cannot detect zero-day vulnerabilities; lacks AI reasoning and human-readable explanations.	FalconScan integrates LLM-based reasoning to explain findings in natural language, detects both known and unknown vulnerabilities, and provides detailed remediation guidance.
VirusTotal	Focuses on signature-based malware detection, not comprehensive vulnerability-level analysis; does not include runtime behavior monitoring.	FalconScan performs hybrid analysis combining static, dynamic, and fuzzing methods to detect vulnerabilities at code and runtime levels, including unusual behaviors.
AndroBugs Framework	Offers limited static and dynamic analysis; lacks fuzzing and runtime anomaly detection; minimal contextual reporting.	FalconScan adds sandbox-based dynamic behavior monitoring, static fuzzing for edge-case inputs, and interpretable AI-generated reports.
QARK	Detects only common security issues; no machine learning intelligence; lacks detailed	FalconScan uses AI/LLM models for intelligent classification, context-aware vulnerability explanations, severity

	vulnerability context and adaptive analysis.	scoring, and recommended fixes.
Static Fuzzing Tools (AFL / libFuzzer)	Standalone fuzzers cannot provide structured vulnerability reports or integrate runtime behavior context; purely input-focused.	FalconScan integrates static fuzzing into the hybrid analysis pipeline, automatically generating mutated inputs, testing APK components, and reporting anomalies with explanations.

1.9 Tools and Technologies

Table 1.2: Tools and Technologies for Proposed Project

Tools and Technologies	**Purpose**	**Rationale**
Python (Django + DRF)	Backend APIs, APK analysis, reporting	Robust, scalable, and widely used for AI-integrated web applications.
Next.js 16 + React 18	Frontend development, dashboard UI	Component-based, fast, interactive, supports modern TypeScript features.
Tailwind CSS, Radix UI, Recharts	UI styling, components, data visualization	Provides responsive, accessible, and visually appealing dashboards.
Axios, Sonner, cmdk	API calls, notifications, command palette	Simplifies REST communication and improves UX.
TensorFlow / PyTorch (optional)	AI model training and inference	Enables machine learning-based vulnerability classification and reasoning.
AFL / libFuzzer (Python wrapper)	Static fuzzing	Automatically generates malformed/boundary-case inputs to detect robustness issues.
OpenAI API / LLM Integration	Natural language vulnerability explanation	Provides interpretable, context-aware reasoning for vulnerabilities.
SQLite	Local database	Lightweight, sufficient for user data and scan metadata; easily extendable.

Android Emulator (AVD)	Dynamic analysis sandbox	Safely monitors runtime app behaviors without real device risk.
Docker (optional)	Deployment and environment management	Ensures reproducibility and isolation across development and production.
ReportLab / PyPDF2	PDF report generation	Generates structured, readable security reports for users.

1.10 Project Contribution

The FalconScan system introduces several technical and conceptual innovations that advance the state-of-the-art in Android application security analysis. Unlike existing solutions, which primarily rely on static or rule-based scanning, FalconScan combines hybrid analysis techniques, AI-driven reasoning, and automated reporting to provide a comprehensive and user-friendly security platform. The project's contributions span multiple dimensions, including innovation, technical design, usability, and integration of modern tools.

Key Contributions:

- **AI-Enhanced Vulnerability Detection:** Implements machine learning classifiers capable of identifying both known and previously unseen vulnerabilities, including obfuscated or zero-day threats, going beyond traditional signature-based detection.
- **LLM-Based Explainability:** Integrates large language models to generate human-readable explanations of identified vulnerabilities, detailing potential impact, root cause, and recommended remediation steps.
- **Hybrid Static and Dynamic Analysis:** Combines static code and manifest analysis with dynamic runtime monitoring in a sandboxed Android emulator, providing comprehensive coverage of potential attack vectors.
- **Static Fuzzing Integration:** Introduces automated fuzz testing within static analysis, generating malformed or boundary-case inputs to detect latent vulnerabilities before runtime execution.

- **Automated End-to-End Workflow:** Fully automates the scan-to-report pipeline, from APK upload to detailed PDF report generation, significantly reducing manual effort and human error.
- **Extensible and Modular Architecture:** Designed to support future integration of additional analysis engines, threat models, AI classifiers, and reporting formats, enabling continuous improvement and scalability.
- **Real-Time and Interactive Reporting:** Provides immediate feedback via an intuitive web dashboard with graphical visualizations, detailed tables, and downloadable reports for developers, QA teams, and security researchers.
- **Secure and Efficient Execution:** Implements role-based access control, sandboxed analysis, and encrypted data handling to maintain operational security and user trust.

Impact:

By integrating AI reasoning, hybrid analysis, and automated workflows, FalconScan transforms traditional vulnerability scanning into a proactive, intelligent, and interpretable platform. It improves detection accuracy, reduces the reliance on expert intervention, and enhances mobile application resilience. Developers and security analysts benefit from clear guidance, actionable insights, and operational efficiency, while the modular design ensures that the system can evolve with emerging threats and modern Android app complexities.

1.11 Relevance to Course Modules

- **Software Engineering Concepts:** Applied full SDLC phases, including requirement analysis, system design, implementation, and testing.
- **Artificial Intelligence / Machine Learning:** Integrated ML classifiers and LLMs for intelligent APK vulnerability detection, classification, and explanation.
- **Database Systems:** Designed structured storage for users, scans, and vulnerability data using SQLite (or PostgreSQL for larger deployments).
- **Web Technologies:** Built full-stack web application using Next.js + React for frontend and Django for backend APIs and services.

- **Information Security:** Implemented secure JWT authentication, sandboxed Android emulator execution, static/dynamic analysis, and data encryption.
- **Cloud Computing / DevOps:** Used Docker to ensure environment consistency, reproducible deployment, and scalable execution.

2 Chapter 2: Requirement Analysis

This chapter provides a detailed analysis of the requirements for the FalconScan system. The purpose of this chapter is to define and understand what the proposed software must accomplish in terms of both functionality and performance. It outlines the user classes and their interactions, the system's functional and non-functional requirements, and its external interface needs. This requirement analysis forms the foundation for subsequent design, development, and implementation phases of FalconScan – an AI-powered APK Vulnerability Scanner that intelligently analyzes Android applications for potential security risks through both static and dynamic analysis.

2.1 User Classes and Characteristics

FalconScan is designed for a variety of users ranging from developers to security professionals. Each user class interacts with the system differently depending on their role, responsibilities, and level of technical expertise. The following table defines each identified user class and its pertinent characteristics.

Table 2.1: User classes in the system

User Class	Description
Application Developer	The primary user who uploads Android APK files to scan for vulnerabilities. Developers use FalconScan to identify and fix potential threats such as insecure permissions, data leaks, or embedded malware. They have access to scan reports, vulnerability breakdowns, and AI-generated recommendations.
Security Analyst	A user who performs detailed analysis on scan reports and verifies AI-generated findings. Analysts may also use the system to test known malware or suspicious apps in a controlled environment to validate FalconScan's detection performance.
Administrator	The system administrator manages user accounts, controls system configurations, and monitors scanning operations and logs. Administrators have full privileges to update the AI model, manage API keys, and ensure smooth operation of the system.

Researcher	Users involved in cybersecurity research who use FalconScan's dataset and analytical outputs for vulnerability pattern studies. Researchers interact with scan results and statistical summaries but do not modify core system settings.
Guest User	A limited-access user who can perform demo scans or view general information about FalconScan without registration. This class is mainly intended for showcasing the platform's capabilities to potential users or evaluators.

2.1.1 Use case Diagram

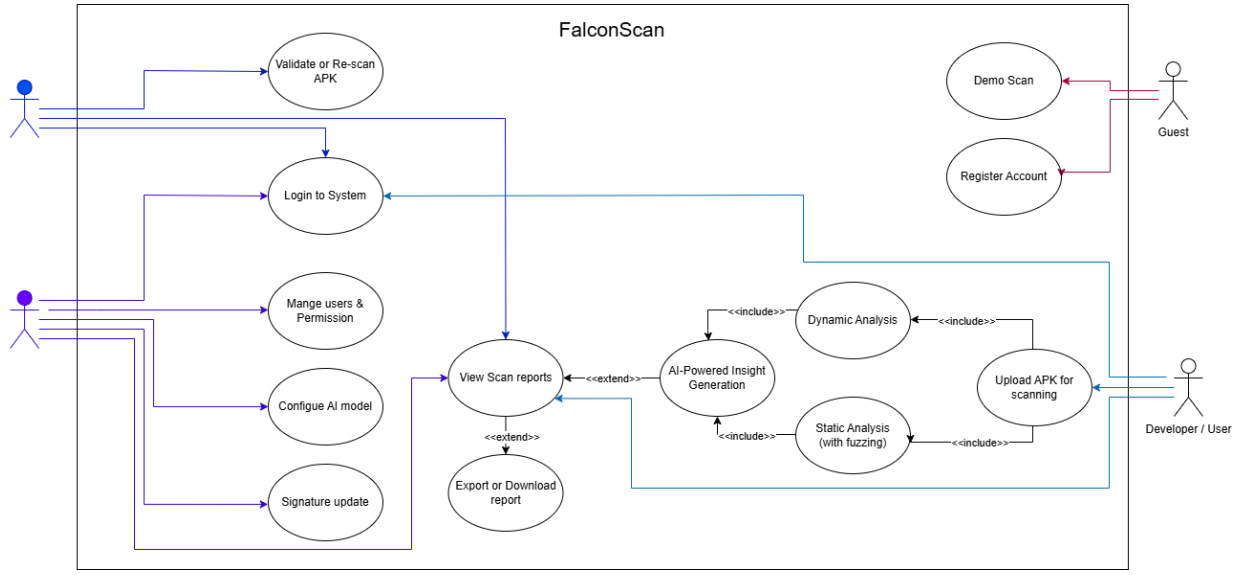


Figure 2.1: Use case diagram

2.1.2 Requirement Identifying Technique

For this project, **Mockup-Based Requirement Analysis** is used. This approach focuses on deriving functional requirements directly from the designed user interface mockups. Each mockup corresponds to a specific user interaction screen in FalconScan.

Steps Followed

1. Identified key features of FalconScan and represented each through a corresponding mockup.
2. Assigned Mockup IDs:
3. Created UI mockups that visualize each screen's layout and features.
4. Identified interactive elements such as buttons, upload fields, report cards, and filters.
5. Derived functional requirements based on the expected system behavior when these elements are used.
6. Organized all requirements using a tabular format (as shown in Section 2.2.1).

Backend Process Requirements

While the mockup-based technique effectively captures frontend behavior, FalconScan also includes extensive backend processes for file analysis, AI-based classification, and report generation.
For these, the Event–Response Table technique is used to define system behavior based on specific backend triggers and events.

Examples include:

- Handling file uploads and initiating analysis workflows.
- Running AI-based vulnerability detection models.
- Generating reports and storing historical scan data.

2.2 Functional Requirements

This section documents all the functional requirements derived from FalconScan's user interface mockups (M1–M5) and backend processes. Each requirement is defined clearly, testably, and traceably.

2.2.1 Mockup M1 – Login Page

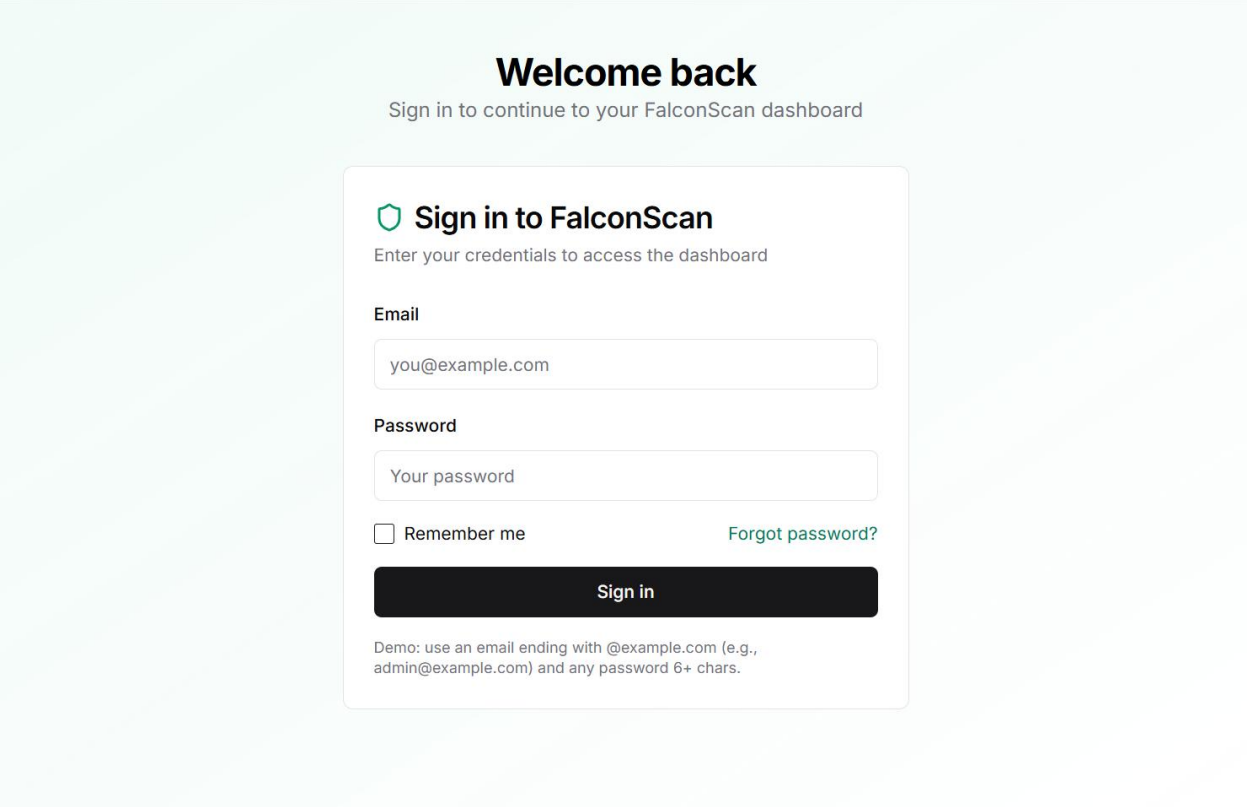


Figure 2.2: Login page

Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M1 – Login Page

Table 2.2: Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M1

Feature	Functional Requirement	Business Rule
User Sign-In	**FR1.1:** System shall allow users to log in using valid email and password credentials.	Email must follow RFC 5322 format; Password must be ≥ 8 characters.
Credential Validation	**FR1.2:** System shall validate user credentials against the authentication database.	Accounts locked after 5 failed attempts.
Password Recovery	**FR1.3:** System shall provide a "Forgot Password" option for verified users.	OTP or reset link expires after 10 minutes.
Session	**FR1.4:** System shall maintain user sessions	Token expires after 30 minutes

Management	using secure JWT tokens.	of inactivity.
Role-Based Redirect	**FR1.6:** System shall redirect users to pages based on role (Admin/Analyst/Standard User).	Only Admins see “Model Management” and “User Management”.

2.2.2 Mockup M2 – Dashboard Page

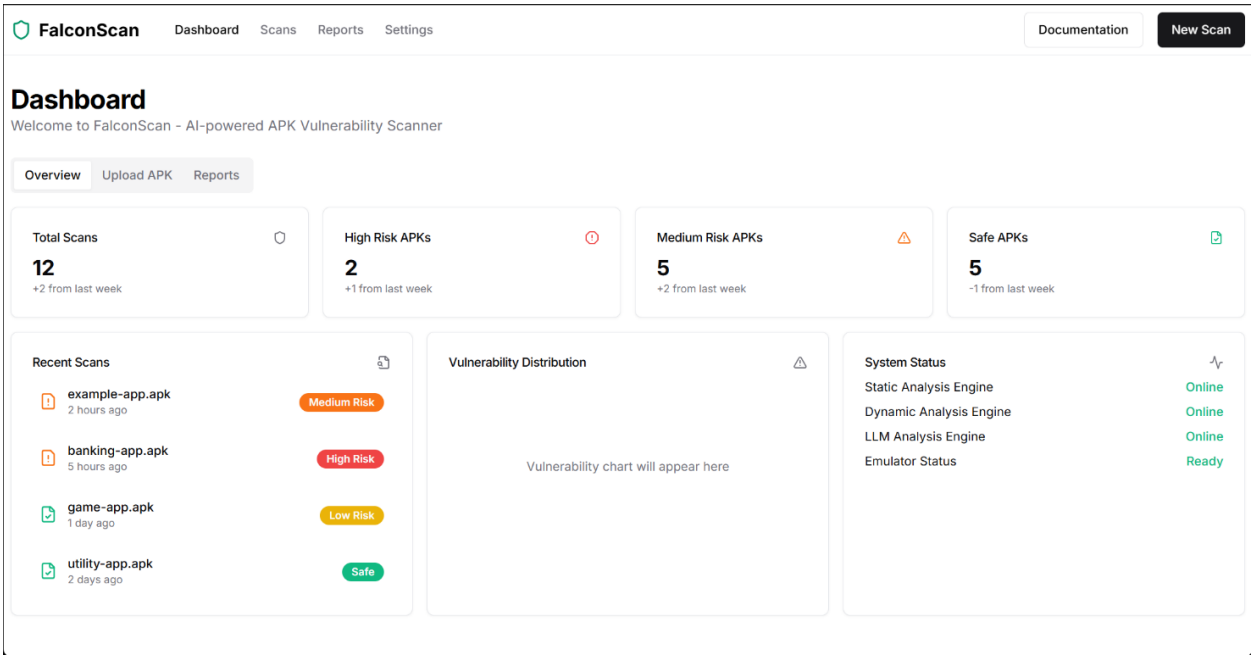


Figure 2.3: Dashboard Page

Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M2 – Dashboard Page

Table 2.3: Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M2

Feature	Functional Requirement	Business Rule
User Overview	**FR2.1:** System shall display user profile information and scan statistics.	Data refreshes every 5 seconds.
Navigation	**FR2.2:** System shall provide navigation to Upload, Reports, History, Settings, and Admin Panel (if applicable).	Menu items depend on user role.
Dashboard Widgets	**FR2.3:** System shall show widgets: total scans, vulnerabilities detected, AI confidence, last	Widgets update dynamically from

	activity.	analytics engine.
Recent Activity Log	**FR2.4:** System shall show last 10 system activities for the logged-in user.	Logs are stored for 90 days.
System Notifications	**FR2.5:** System shall display notifications such as “Scan Completed”, “Model Updated”, etc.	Notifications auto-expire after 7 days.
Admin Analytics	**FR2.6:** System shall show global analytics only to Admin (total platform scans, trending vulnerabilities).	Accessible only with Admin role.
Dark/Light Theme Toggle	**FR2.7:** System shall support UI theme toggling.	User preference saved in profile settings.

2.2.3 Mockup M3 – Upload APK Page

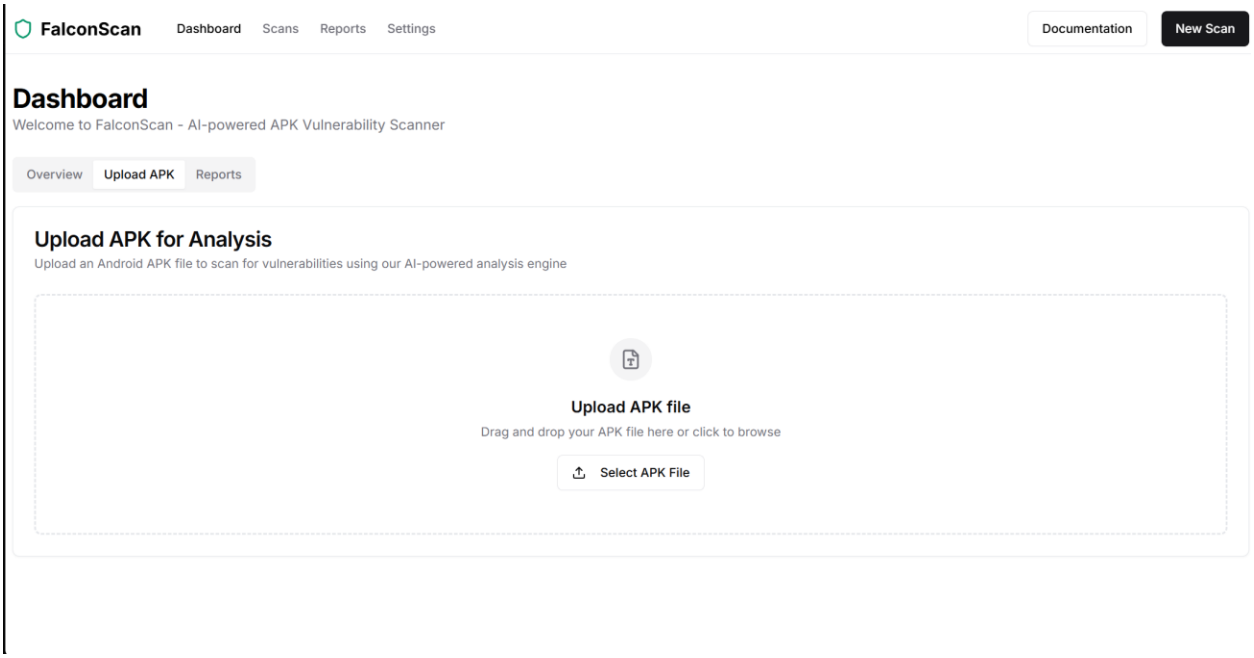


Figure 2.4: Upload APK Page

Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M3 – Upload APK Page

Table 2.4: Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M3

Feature	Functional Requirement	Business Rule
APK Upload	**FR3.1:** System shall allow upload of APK files for analysis.	Max size 200 MB. Only `.apk` allowed.
Automated Analysis	**FR3.2:** System shall automatically trigger Static & Dynamic analysis after upload.	No analysis begins if file signature is invalid.
Scan Progress	**FR3.3:** System shall show real-time scan progress bars for each stage.	User can cancel scan only before "Analysis Phase".
Access Control	**FR3.4:** System shall restrict uploads to authenticated users.	Guest users can only run demo scans with sample APK.
Fuzzing Configuration	**FR3.5:** System shall allow advanced users to configure fuzzing options such as input size, execution cycles, and target components.	Only Admins/Analysts have access to advanced fuzz settings.
File Validation	**FR3.6:** System shall validate file integrity using checksums before analysis.	Reject corrupted or incomplete APKs.
Duplicate Scan Handling	**FR3.7:** If a file has been scanned before, system shows past results and offers "Re-scan".	Hash-based duplicate detection.
Upload History Preview	**FR3.8:** System shall show last 5 uploaded APKs as shortcuts.	Visible only to current user.
Dependency Extraction	**FR3.9:** System shall perform extraction of app metadata (permissions, activities, libraries).	Must complete before static analysis stage.
Scan Queue Management	**FR3.10:** If server is busy, system shall place uploads into queue.	Queue position displayed to the user.

2.2.4 Mockup M4 – Scan Reports Page

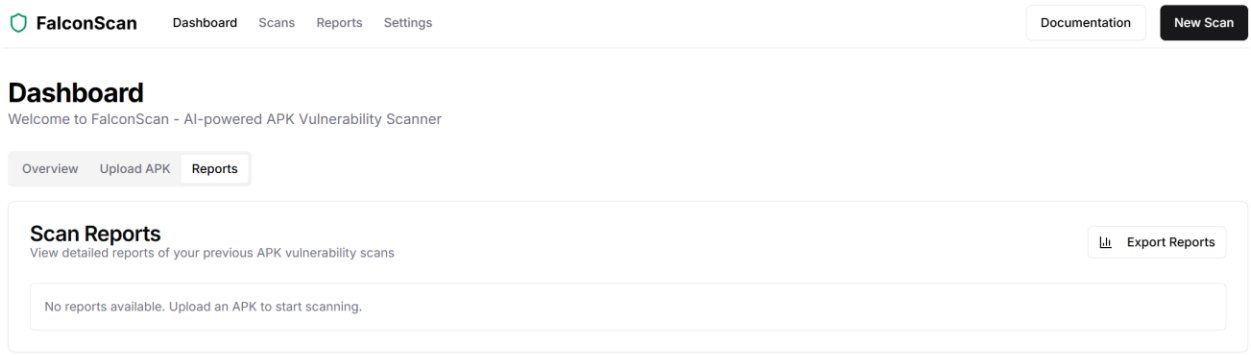


Figure 2.5: Scan Reports Page

Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M4 – Scan Reports Page

Table 2.5: Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M4

Feature	Functional Requirement	Business Rule
Vulnerability Display	**FR4.1:** System shall display all vulnerabilities categorized by severity.	Severity follows CVSS 3.1 metrics.
AI Explanations	**FR4.2:** System shall generate AI explanations for each finding.	Must be concise, technical, and accurate.
Report Export	**FR4.3:** System shall export reports in PDF, JSON, and CSV (NEW).	Only owner or Admin can export.
False Positive Marking	**FR4.4:** System shall allow users to mark vulnerabilities as verified or false-positive.	Feedback updates AI training pipeline.
Technical Remediation	**FR4.5:** System shall provide fix recommendations for each vulnerability.	Recommendations follow OWASP MASVS.
Code Snippet Extraction	**FR4.6:** System shall highlight decompiled code segments linked to vulnerabilities.	Only static findings produce snippets.
Behaviour Timeline	**FR4.7:** System shall show dynamic behavior timeline (network calls, I/O, permissions).	Based on dynamic sandbox logs.
AI Confidence Score	**FR4.8:** System shall display AI confidence % for each finding.	Scores must be between 0–100%.
Risk Summary Chart	**FR4.9:** System shall show graphical charts (severity distribution, module-level risk).	Charts updated in real time.

2.2.5 Mockup M5 – Scan History Page

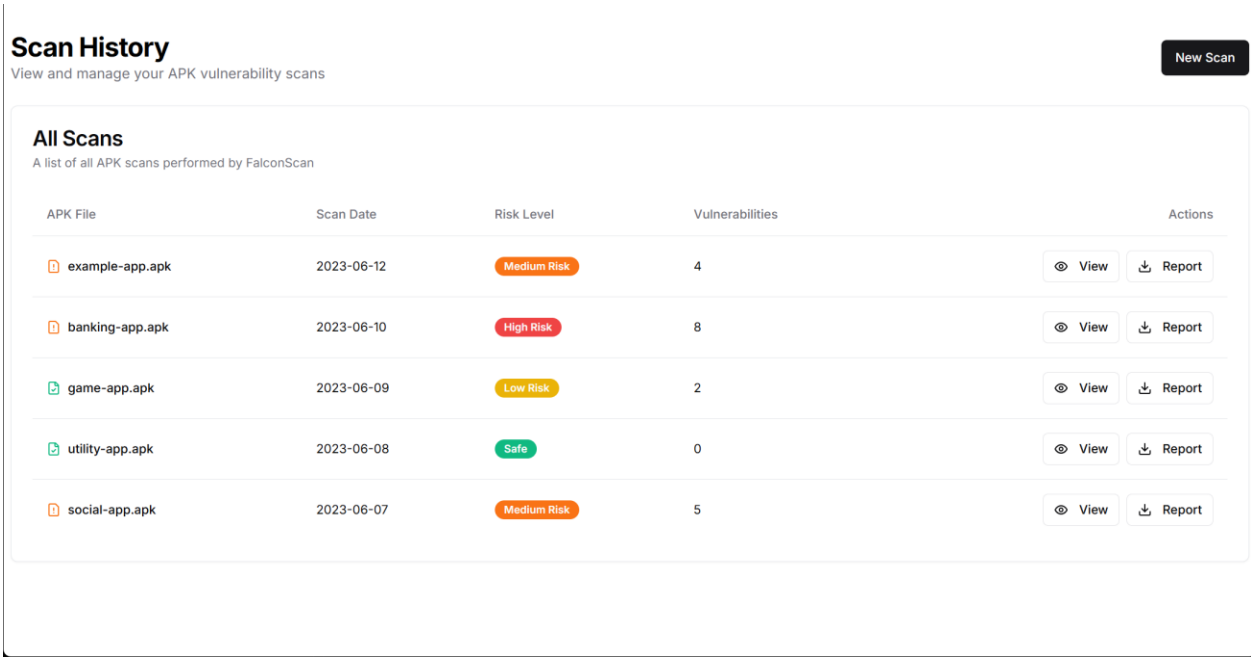


Figure 2.6: Scan Reports Page

Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M5 – Scan History Page

Table 2.6: Functional Requirements Derived from Mockup M5

Feature	Functional Requirement	Business Rule
Scan Records	**FR5.1:** System shall maintain chronological scan history.	Includes date, filename, hash, size, and status.
Filtering	**FR5.2:** System shall allow filtering by date, severity level, scan type, or result.	Max 100 records per page.
Rescan	**FR5.3:** System shall allow re-scanning past files.	Only original uploader can re-scan.
Delete Record	**FR5.4:** System shall allow users to delete their own scan history entries.	Irreversible once deleted.
Bulk Actions	**FR5.5:** System shall support bulk export or bulk delete.	Maximum 20 selections at a time.
Search Function	**FR5.6:** System shall provide search by filename, hash, or result.	Search supports substring matching.

Archive Old Scans	**FR5.7:** System shall automatically archive scans older than 90 days.	Archived scans stored in cold storage.

2.2.6 Event–Response Table for Backend Processes

Table 2.7: Event–Response Table for FalconScan

Event	System State	System Response
User uploads APK	File received	System verifies file signature → stores temporary copy → adds job to queue.
Static analyzer detects insecure permission	Static analysis phase	System logs finding → assigns severity → stores metadata.
Static analyzer finds obfuscated code	Static analysis phase	System flags potential malware → sends data to AI model.
Dynamic analyzer detects suspicious network request	Runtime sandboxing	System stores PCAP logs → extracts endpoints → adds to report.
Fuzzing analysis initiated	Fuzzer active	System generates test payloads → executes inside instrumented environment.
Fuzzing detects abnormal behavior	Fuzzer runtime	System logs crash, stack traces, memory corruption patterns.
AI model completes classification	Post-analysis stage	Generates predictions → sorts vulnerabilities → generates explanations.
Model fails to classify	AI timeout/error	System triggers fallback rule-based detection mechanism.
User requests report export	Ready for export	System formats file into PDF/JSON/CSV and triggers download.
Admin updates AI model	Model management module	System archives old model → deploys new version → logs update.
Scan queue overloaded	Queue threshold exceeded	System notifies user and provides estimated wait time.
Database connection failure	Error handler	System retries operation 3 times → logs

	active	error → notifies Admin.
Sandbox detects evasion attempt	Dynamic execution	System flags sample as evasive → increases severity score.

2.3 Non-Functional Requirements

2.3.1 Reliability

- **REL-1:** The system shall maintain a minimum uptime of 99.5% under normal operating conditions.
- **REL-2:** The system shall have a Mean Time Between Failures (MTBF) of at least 500 **hours**.
- **REL-3:** All scan progress shall be auto-saved every 30 seconds to prevent data loss during system failure.
- **REL-4:** In the event of an analysis crash, the system shall resume from the last saved state.

2.3.2 Usability

- **USE-1:** The system shall allow first-time users to complete a full scan process (upload → report) within 3 intuitive clicks**.**
- **USE-2:** The user interface shall maintain consistent color schemes, icons, and typography across all pages.
- **USE-3:** Tooltips and help sections shall be available for all major features.
- **USE-4:** The platform shall be accessible via both desktop and mobile browsers with responsive design.

2.3.3 Performance

- **PER-1:** 90% of scans for APKs under 100 MB shall complete within 3 minutes on standard cloud infrastructure.

- **PER-2:** 95% of pages shall load fully within 4 seconds over a 20 Mbps connection.
- **PER-3:** Concurrent scanning sessions shall support at least 50 simultaneous users without degradation.

2.3.4 Security

- **SEC-1:** The system shall use HTTPS for all communications between client and server.
- **SEC-2:** Uploaded files shall be isolated in sandboxed environments to prevent system compromise.
- **SEC-3:** All user data shall be encrypted in transit and at rest using AES-256.
- **SEC-4:** The system shall automatically log all access attempts and notify the admin of failed authentication exceeding 5 consecutive attempts.
- **SEC-5:** The AI model training data shall be anonymized and stored securely.

2.4 External Interface Requirements

2.4.1 User Interface Requirements

The FalconScan UI shall follow a clean, consistent design standard based on Material UI principles.
Key UI requirements include:

- Standardized color palette: dark theme with accent highlights.
- Font: Open Sans or Roboto, consistent across all screens.
- Every page shall include a top navigation bar with Home, Dashboard, Upload, Reports, and History links.
- Common buttons such as “Scan”, “Export”, and “Logout” will be present on applicable screens.
- All error messages will appear in red banners at the top of the interface with clear descriptions.
- A help icon (“?”) will appear on each screen for guidance.

- The interface shall support accessibility features such as screen reader compatibility and high-contrast mode.

2.4.2 Software Interfaces

Table 2.8: Software Interfaces

Interface ID	Description
SI-1: AI Model API	The system shall communicate with a Python-based vulnerability detection API for AI processing.
SI-2: Database Interface	The system shall interact with a PostgreSQL database for user, scan, and report management.
SI-3: Emulator Service	The system shall interface with an Android emulator API to perform dynamic runtime analysis.
SI-4: Report Generator Module	The system shall generate and export reports via an integrated Python report generation library.

2.4.3 Hardware Interfaces

FalconScan runs primarily on cloud-based infrastructure but requires access to specific hardware during analysis:

- Android emulator host machines with at least 8 GB RAM and 4 CPU cores for dynamic testing.
- Server instances capable of GPU acceleration for AI model inference.
- Secure storage devices for maintaining uploaded APKs and scan results.

2.4.4 Communication Interfaces

Table 2.9: Communication Interfaces

Communication ID	Requirement
CI-1:	The system shall communicate over HTTPS using TLS 1.3 protocol.

CI-2:	The system shall send email notifications to users upon completion of scans.
CI-3:	The system shall allow API communication for integration with third-party tools.
CI-4:	The system shall log all internal communications for traceability and debugging.

3 Chapter 3: Design and Architecture

This chapter presents the complete architectural design of the proposed FalconScan Android APK Vulnerability Analysis System. It covers the conceptual system architecture, architectural patterns, design models, data representations, and the rationale behind the architectural decisions taken during the system's development. The chapter also explains how the different system modules interact with each other to form a cohesive, secure, scalable, and extensible full-stack security analysis platform.

FalconScan uses a Hybrid Architecture that combines the strengths of three major architectural approaches:

1. **Client–Server Architecture**
   Used for communication between the Next.js frontend and the Django REST API server.
2. **Layered Architecture**
   Used within the backend to separate presentation, business logic, analysis engines, AI reasoning, and database layers.
3. **Modular Pipeline Architecture**
   Used in the analysis engine where each module (static analysis, dynamic analysis, fuzzing, AI reasoning, reporting) works independently, is replaceable, and can be extended without affecting other components.

This hybrid approach ensures scalability, maintainability, high system clarity, and extensibility as the APK scanning logic grows over time.

3.1 System Architecture Overview

This section provides the high-level external architectural design of the FalconScan system. It includes the major components, technologies, communication flow, and security controls used across the system. Unlike the internal architecture patterns (Layered, MVC, etc.), this section focuses on the **macroscopic view** to help stakeholders understand how the entire system behaves as a whole.

FalconScan is structured as a cloud-enabled, full-stack APK scanning and reporting platform accessed through a web-based dashboard. Users interact with the system through the Next.js 16 web client, which communicates with the Django REST Framework backend responsible for authenticating users, managing scans, executing static and dynamic analysis, performing AI-based reasoning, and generating PDF reports.

Uploaded APKs are securely stored under the backend's media repository and passed through multiple hybrid analysis stages, including manifest parsing, permission analysis, opcode inspection, string extraction, anomaly detection, LLM-based reasoning, and PDF report generation. All results, metadata, and analytic insights are stored in the relational database.

3.1.1 Purpose

The purpose of this section is to illustrate a conceptual overview of FalconScan. It presents the big-picture structure of the system and identifies major functional modules, data flows, and high-level communication pathways. This helps stakeholders understand:

- What the system contains
- Where each module resides
- How subsystems communicate
- Which technologies are used
- How data and control signals move across components
- What security defenses protect the system

This conceptual view serves as a foundation for understanding deeper architectural decisions presented later in the chapter.

3.2 Guidelines for Students

The conceptual architecture diagram visually depicts the core modules of FalconScan and the relationships between them. It identifies the frontend user interface, backend services, authentication subsystem, database storage, analysis pipeline, admin panel, and external integrations. Arrows represent data flow and control signals between components.

3.2.1 Conceptual Architecture Diagram

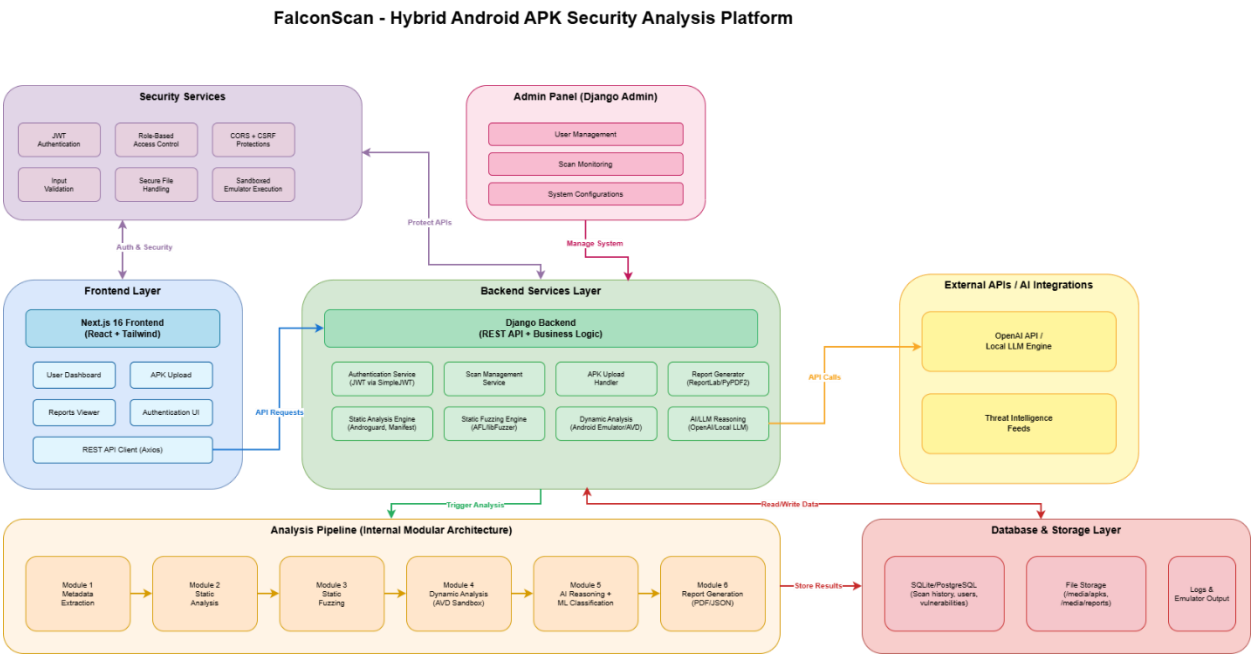


Figure 3.1: Conceptual Architecture diagram

3.2.1.1 Frontend (Next.js / React UI)

The frontend is the primary interaction layer for end-users. It provides authentication pages, APK upload interface, dashboard visualizations, scan history pages, detailed vulnerability reports, and administrator functionalities. The interface is responsive, modular, and optimized for high-performance rendering using React components.

3.2.1.2 Backend Services (Django REST API)

This is the core processing unit of the entire system. It manages authentication, user sessions, scan management, report generation, APK processing, and database interactions. It exposes secure RESTful endpoints consumed by the frontend.

3.2.1.3 Database Layer (SQLite/PostgreSQL)

Stores users, scans, vulnerabilities, metadata, system configurations, and generated reports. The relational model ensures structured, normalized, and indexed data suitable for analytics-heavy workflows.

3.2.1.4 Authentication & Authorization Service

Implements JWT authentication via SimpleJWT. Handles user login, access tokens, refresh tokens, role-based access control (RBAC), and secure session management.

3.2.1.5 Analysis Pipeline

A modular, extensible architecture enabling independent scanning components:

- Static Analysis Module (permissions, manifest, opcode, strings)
- Dynamic Analysis Module (sandbox execution, log capture)
- AI Reasoning Module (LLM vulnerability explanation & scoring)
- Fuzzing Module (optional mutation-based fuzzing)
- Reporting Module (PDF generation)

Each module can be replaced or upgraded without affecting others.

3.2.1.6 Admin Panel

Allows administrators to delete scans, monitor platform usage, manage users, view logs, and maintain system configurations.

3.2.1.7 Security Services

- Encrypted communication using TLS
- JWT token-based authentication
- Input validation

- File safety checks
- RBAC policies
- CORS protection
- Internal sandbox for dynamic analysis

3.2.2 Technologies and Services

Table 3.1: Technologies, Components, and Security Mechanisms Used in the System Architecture

Component	Description	Technology Used	Security Mechanism
Frontend App	User-facing interface for APK uploads, dashboards, and report viewing	Next.js 16, React 18, Tailwind CSS	SSL/TLS, Input Validation, Secure Storage
Backend API	Business logic, scan processing, and communication with analysis modules	Django 4.2, Django REST Framework	JWT, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), CORS Protection
Database	Structured data storage for users, scans, vulnerabilities, reports	SQLite (development), PostgreSQL (production-ready)	RBAC, Encrypted Storage (optional), ORM-level input sanitization
Authentication Service	Token-based identity and session management	SimpleJWT (Django)	Access Tokens, Refresh Tokens, Expiration Policies
Analysis Engine	Hybrid multi-stage APK analysis modules	Androguard, PyAXMLParser, ADB-based dynamic analysis, Python ML	Sandbox Isolation, File Validation
Admin Panel	Administrative management dashboard	React (within Next.js)	Admin Authorization, 2FA (optional), Audit Logs

AI Reasoning Service	LLM-based vulnerability interpretation and report enrichment	Integrated LLM APIs	Secure API Key Management
Reporting Engine	Automated PDF report generation	ReportLab, PyPDF2	Integrity Validation, Secure File Storage

3.3Architecture Style / Pattern

FalconScan uses a **Hybrid Architecture Pattern** that integrates:

- **Client–Server Architecture**
- **Layered Architecture**
- **Modular Pipeline Architecture**

This combination allows the system to be scalable, extensible, and maintainable while supporting complex APK analysis operations.

3.3.1 Selected Architecture Pattern & Justification

The FalconScan system uses a combination of architectural patterns that work together to ensure scalability, maintainability, and high-performance APK analysis. At the highest level, the platform follows a **Client–Server Architecture**, where the client application (web dashboard) communicates with a centralized backend server through secure HTTP APIs. This separation allows the client to remain lightweight and focused on user interaction while the backend handles all heavy processing tasks such as static analysis, dynamic execution, fuzzing, and AI-driven vulnerability classification. The client–server model is ideal here because it ensures a secure communication channel, supports authenticated user access, and keeps all sensitive APK processing inside a controlled server environment rather than exposing it on the client side.

Inside the backend, the system applies a **Layered Architecture**, dividing the server into well-defined layers: the Presentation Layer exposes REST API endpoints for authentication, APK

upload, and report retrieval; the Business Logic Layer manages user workflows, orchestrates scan operations, and enforces application rules; the Scanning & AI Processing Layer contains specialized engines responsible for static analysis, dynamic behavior monitoring, fuzzing, and AI reasoning; the Data Access Layer (DAL) uses Django ORM repositories to abstract database operations; and the Storage Layer handles the physical storage of APK files, logs, scan results, and generated reports. This layered design reduces coupling between components, making the system easier to extend and maintain—updates to one layer do not affect others as long as the interfaces remain consistent.

The scanning engine itself follows a **Modular Pipeline Architecture**, where analysis tasks are broken into modular, sequential stages. Each module—Static Analysis, Dynamic Analysis, Fuzzing, AI Interpretation, and Reporting—operates independently and communicates through structured intermediate results. This modularity ensures that any component can be extended, improved, or even replaced (e.g., upgrading the static analyzer or swapping the AI model) without disrupting the rest of the pipeline. The pipeline model allows parallel development, simplifies debugging, and ensures that the overall scanning process is systematic, reproducible, and optimized for handling large numbers of APKs. Overall, the combination of these three architectural patterns provides a robust, scalable, and secure foundation for FalconScan's APK vulnerability scanning workflow.

3.3.2 Architecture Style Diagrams

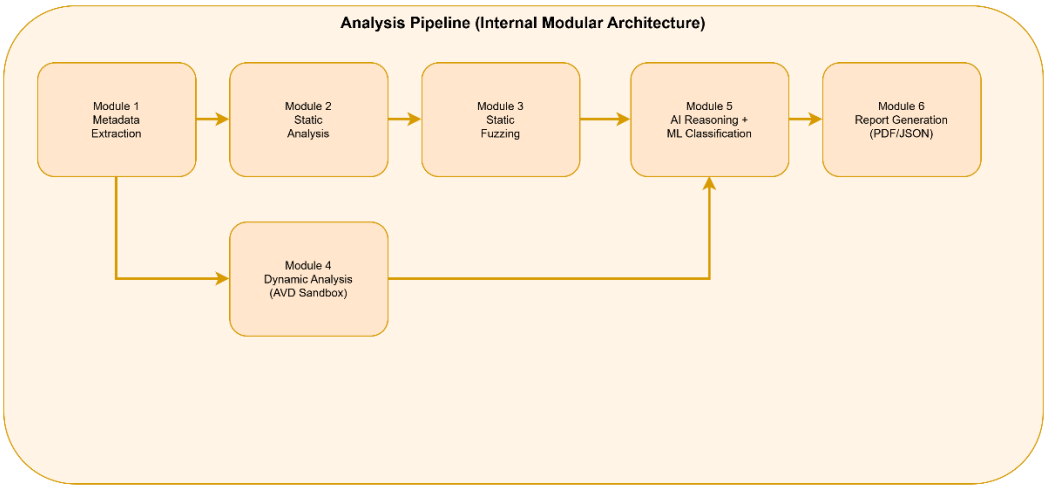


Figure 3.2: Pipeline Architecture

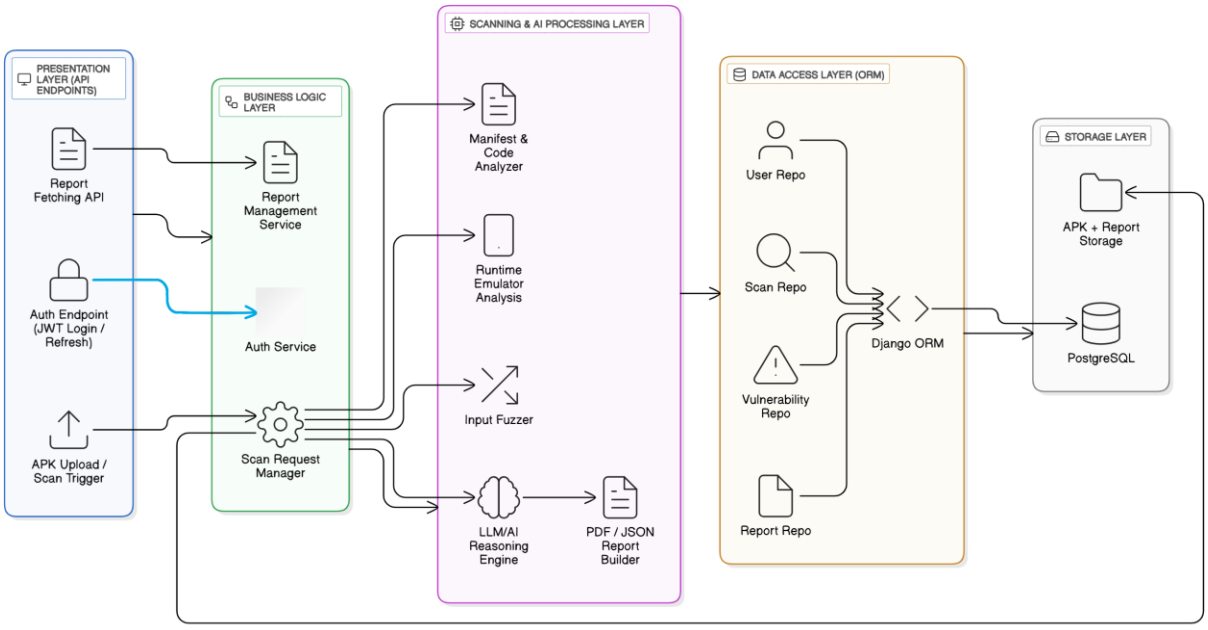


Figure 3.3: Layered Architecture inside the backend

3.4 Design Models

This section provides a comprehensive overview of the key design models used in FalconScan, an Android APK security platform. These models are developed using the object-oriented development (OOD) approach, which emphasizes modularity, encapsulation, inheritance, and reusability. The design models included here focus on core workflows, important system components, and critical processes that are central to FalconScan's functionality, rather than trivial operations such as login/logout or simple CRUD actions.

Object-oriented design models help in visualizing the internal structure of the system, understanding the relationships between classes, and clarifying the flow of control and data among objects. By using these models, developers, testers, and stakeholders can grasp the architecture, behavior, and responsibilities of major system components, facilitating maintenance, extension, and collaboration.

3.4.1 Design Models for Object Oriented Development Approach

3.4.1.1 Activity Diagram

1. Apk upload

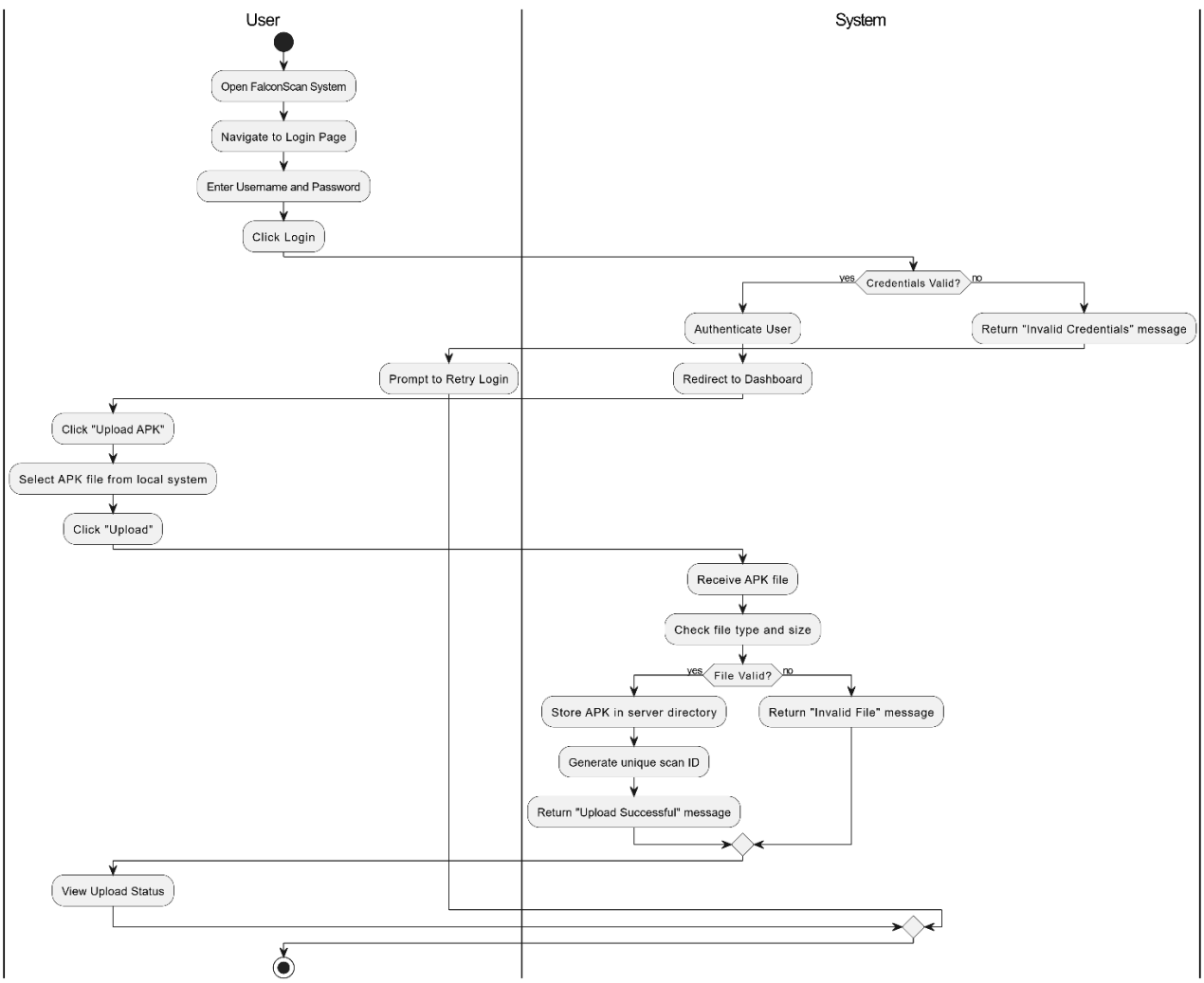


Figure 3.4: Activity Diagram 1 – Apk upload

2. Static Analysis and Fuzzing

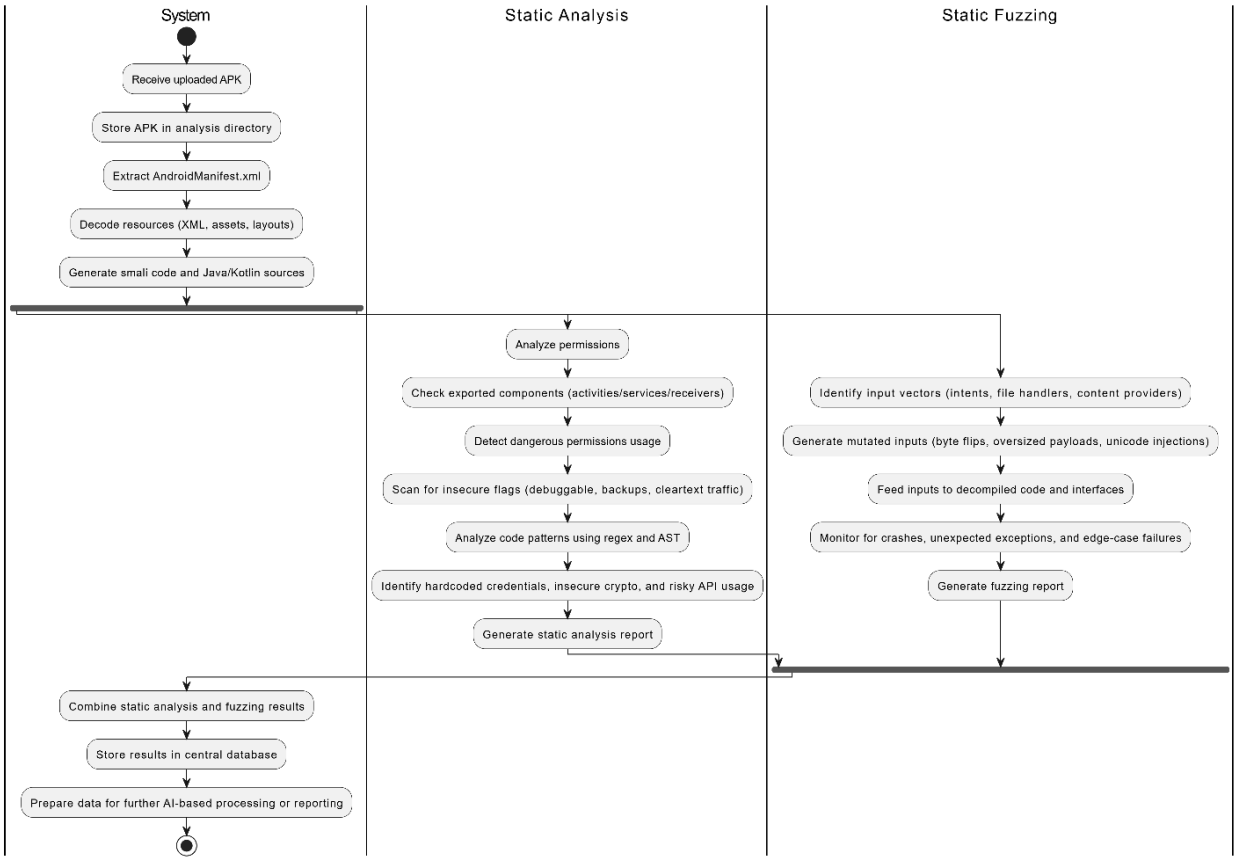


Figure 3.5: Activity Diagram 2 - Static Analysis and Fuzzing

3. Dynamic Analysis

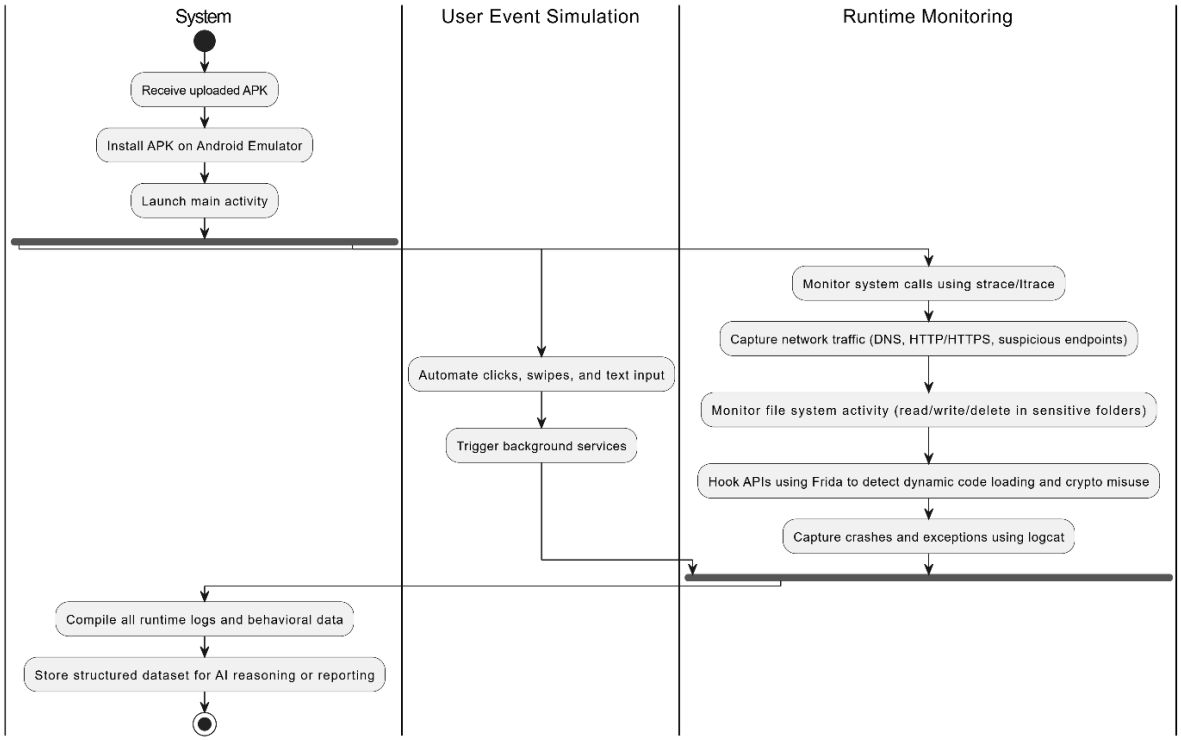


Figure 3.6: Activity Diagram 3 - Dynamic Analysis

4. AI/LLM

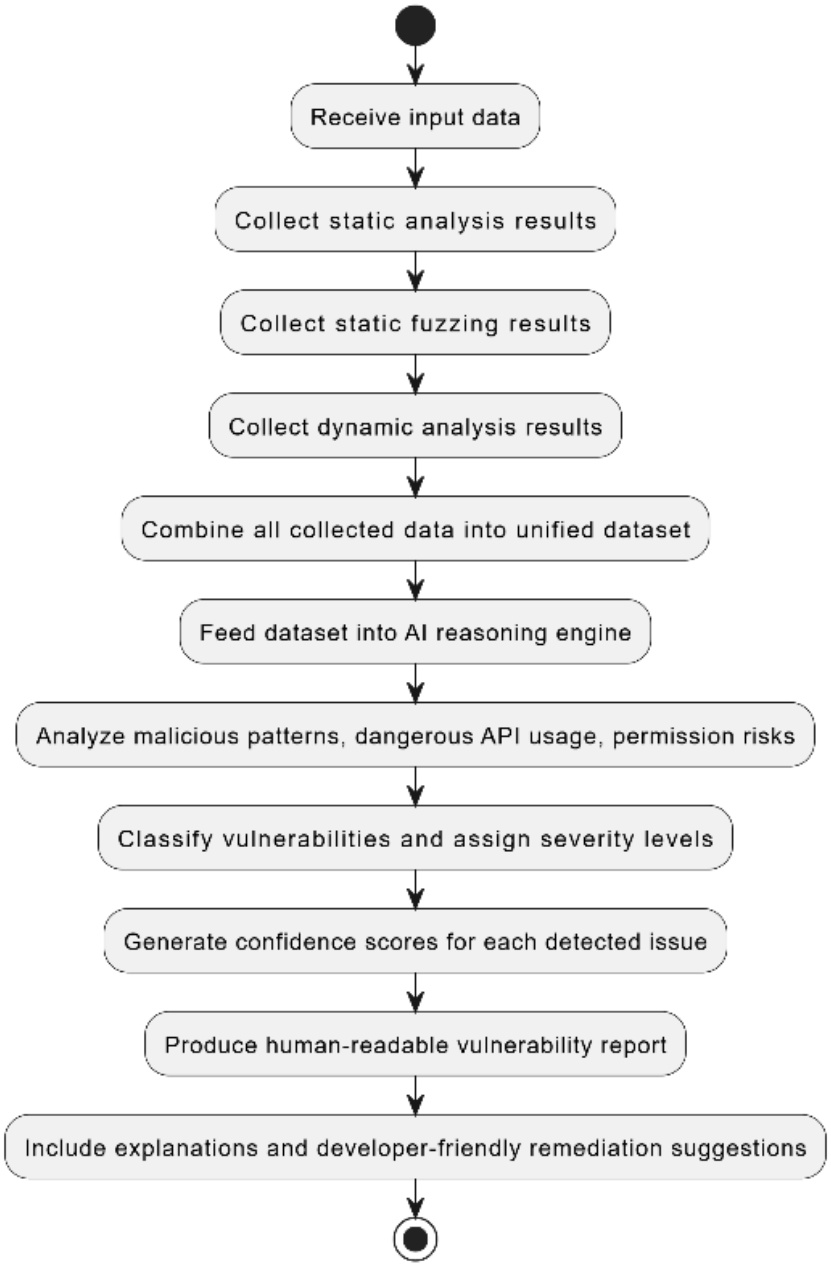


Figure 3.7: Activity Diagram 4 – AI/LLM

5. Reporting

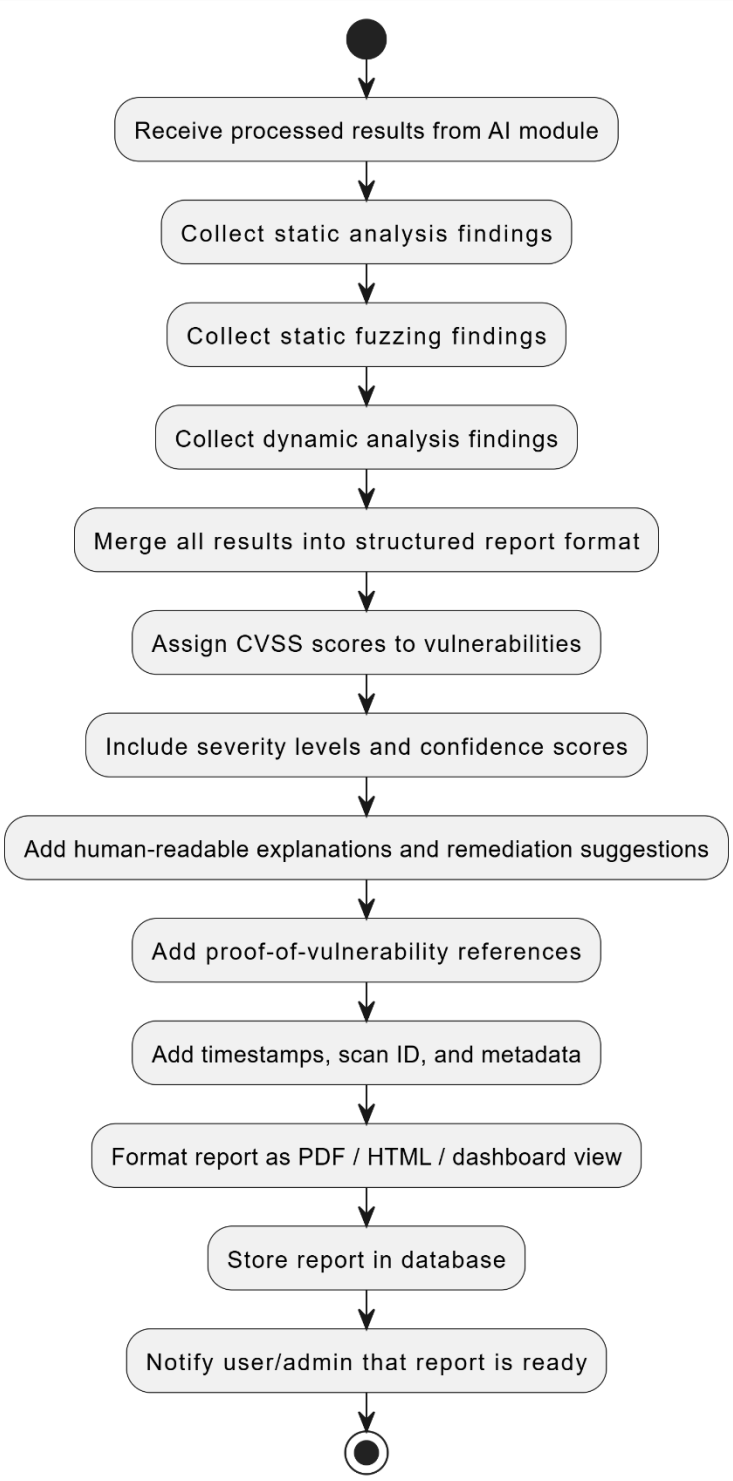


Figure 3.8: Activity Diagram 5 – Report generation

3.4.1.2 Class Diagram

The class diagram provides a structural view of the system, highlighting the main classes, their attributes, methods, and the relationships among them. FalconScan's backend is primarily built using Django, and the frontend interacts with APIs via React/Next.js components.

Key Classes Included in the Diagram:

- **User** – Represents system users, including administrators and regular users. Key attributes include id, username, email, and is_staff. Core methods manage user state and permissions.
- **Scan** – Central model representing each APK scan. Attributes include app_name, file_path, threat_level, status, and hash_md5. Methods include __str__() for display purposes.
- **Vulnerability** – Associated with a specific scan, capturing information about detected vulnerabilities, such as vuln_type, description, severity, and location.
- **Permission** – Tracks granted permissions in APKs and links users to scans. Attributes include permission_type and granted_at.
- **Report** – Stores generated security reports, including report_path, generated_at, and status.
- **Serializers** – UserSerializer, RegisterSerializer, ScanSerializer, and ScanCreateSerializer handle validation and conversion between model instances and JSON responses for API communication.
- **ViewSets** – UserViewSet and ScanViewSet manage API endpoints for user and scan operations, encapsulating actions like upload, rescan, statistics, and download_pdf.
- **API Helpers** – authAPI and scansAPI manage frontend interactions with the backend, storing tokens and handling authentication flows, including JWT refresh handling.
- **Frontend Components** – LoginPage, UploadPage, and DashboardLayout consume API helpers and represent the interactive interface of the system.

Relationships and Notations:

- **Aggregation** – Scan aggregates multiple Vulnerability and Permission instances, while each Report is linked to a single Scan.
- **Dependency** – ViewSets depend on serializers for data validation, while frontend components depend on API helpers for communication with the backend.
- **Composition** – The backend system is modular, allowing scanning modules (static, dynamic, AI reasoning, reporting) to be replaced or extended independently.



Figure 3.9: Class diagram

3.4.1.3 Sequence Diagram

1. User Authentication

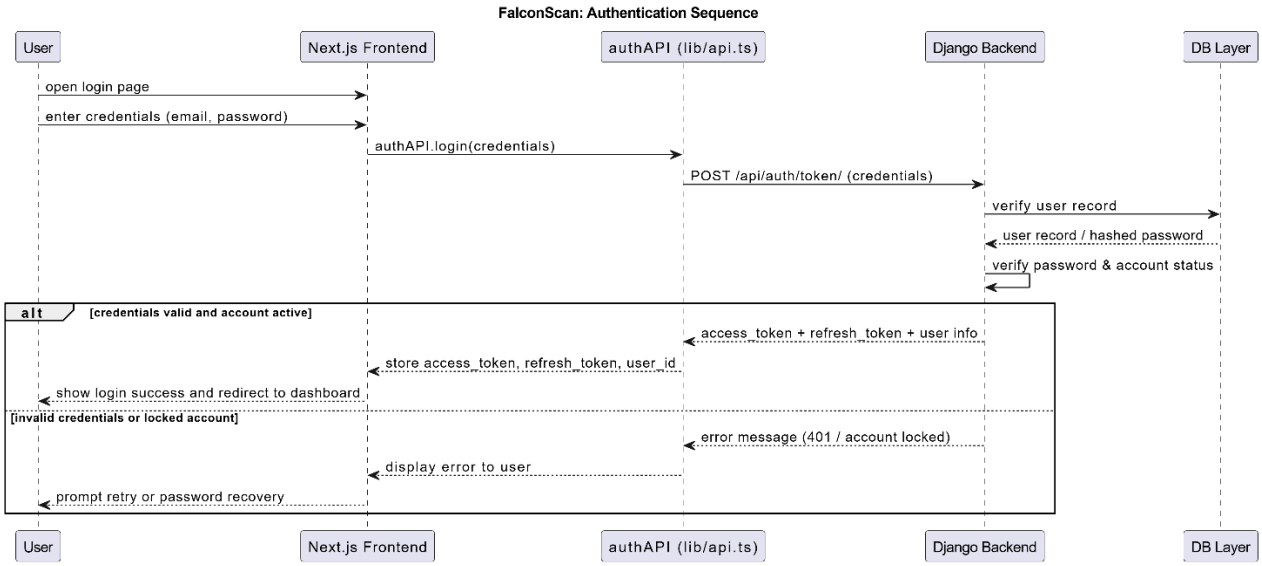


Figure 3.10: Sequence diagram 1 - User authentication

The authentication diagram models the secure login flow used by FalconScan. The user first requests the login form from the frontend and submits credentials. The frontend delegates authentication to the authAPI helper which encapsulates Axios, token handling, and retry behavior. The helper sends the credentials to the Django backend authentication endpoint which looks up the user in the database and compares hashed passwords. If the user exists and the credentials and account state are valid, the backend issues JWT access and refresh tokens along with minimal user metadata. These tokens are returned to the frontend through the authAPI which stores them securely in the client context and local storage according to the design. The frontend then redirects the user to the dashboard. If authentication fails because of bad credentials, account lockout, or other policy checks, the backend returns an appropriate HTTP error; authAPI surfaces that error and the frontend displays an actionable message prompting retry, password recovery, or contacting administrators. Important operational details included

here are account lockout rules, secure hashing verification on the backend, and the separation of concerns where the authAPI handles token storage and refresh logic while the backend enforces policy and state. This pattern guarantees centralized access control, auditability, and a clear place to insert rate limiting, two factor, or CAPTCHA protections later.

2. APK Upload and Scan Initiation

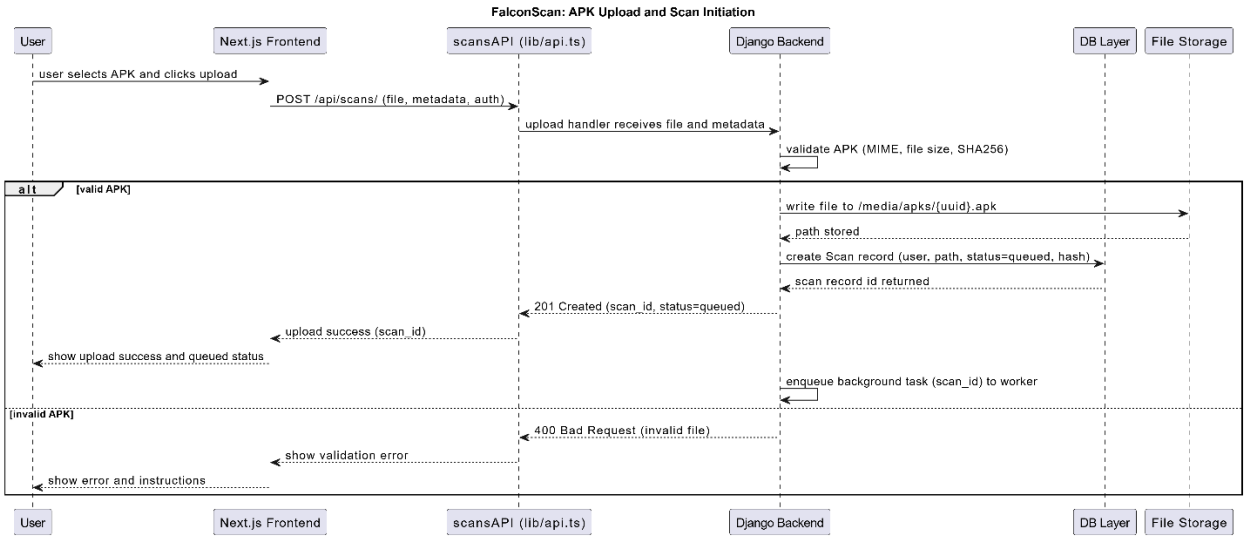


Figure 3.11: Sequence diagram 2- Apk upload

This diagram traces the lifecycle from the user initiating an APK upload to the creation of a scan record and enqueueing of the analysis job. The frontend collects the APK file and metadata and calls the scansAPI which forwards the request to the Django upload endpoint. The backend immediately performs defensive checks including MIME type validation, maximum size enforcement, and a SHA256 checksum to detect duplicates or tampering. If valid, the file is persisted in isolated file storage with a UUID based filename to avoid collisions and path disclosure. The backend persists a Scan model into the database with initial status queued. The API returns the scan identifier and queued status back to the frontend so the user sees immediate feedback. Crucially, the backend then enqueues a background worker job responsible for running the hybrid pipeline to avoid long request timeouts and to scale analysis independently from request throughput. If validation fails, the user receives a clear error message. This flow decouples user interactions from heavy compute tasks, enables retries and auditability, and provides a natural point to insert rate limiting, virus scanning of uploads, or quota checks.

3. Static Analysis Flow

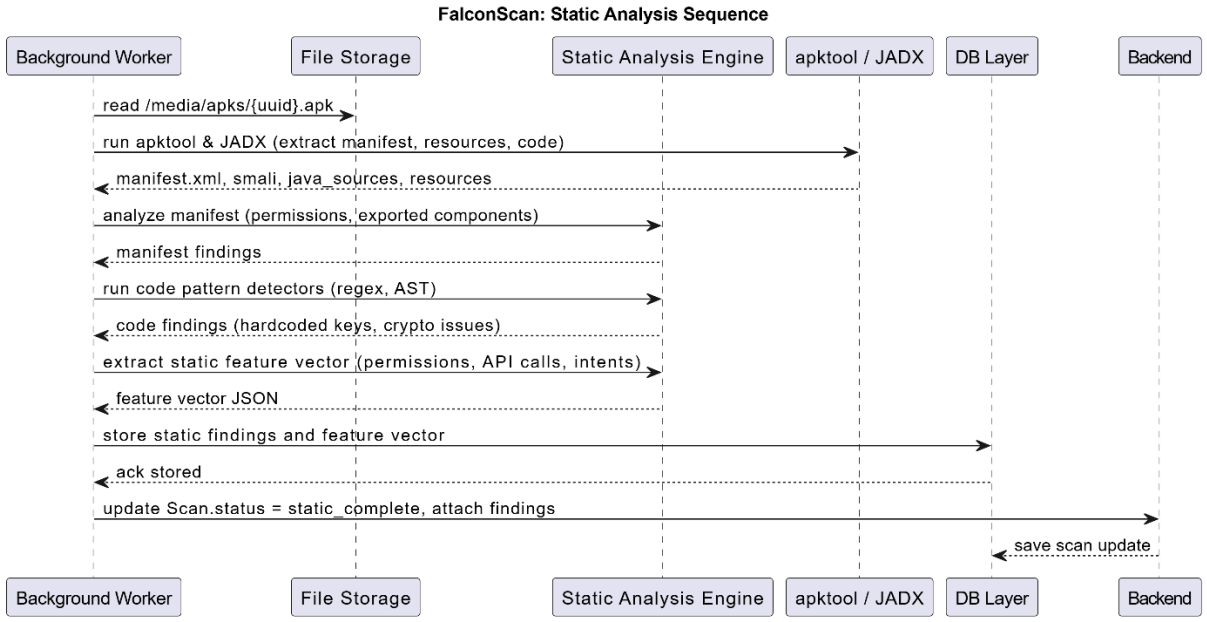


Figure 3.12: Sequence diagram 3 - Static analysis

After the worker picks up the scan job, it reads the uploaded APK from file storage and invokes decompilers such as apktool and JADX to extract the manifest, resource files, smali, and reconstructed Java/Kotlin sources. The static engine performs targeted analysis of the manifest to enumerate permissions, exported activities, receivers, and network config. It applies deterministic rules to flag obvious misconfigurations such as exported components without protection, CLEAR_TEXT traffic allowed, or debuggable builds. Concurrently, code-level pattern detectors examine source files using a combination of regular expressions and AST analysis to find hardcoded credentials, insecure cryptography patterns, suspicious reflection or runtime.exec usage, and other risky API calls. The static engine also extracts a structured feature vector summarizing permissions, API call frequency, intent usage, and suspicious code markers. The worker persists these results into the database and updates the Scan record status to reflect that static analysis is complete. This careful staging ensures traceable evidence for each finding and produces structured inputs for later AI reasoning. Error conditions handled here include decompiler failures, malformed APK contents, or unexpected file encodings; in such cases the worker records an exception entry and updates the scan status to failed with diagnostic logs.

4. Static Fuzzing Flow

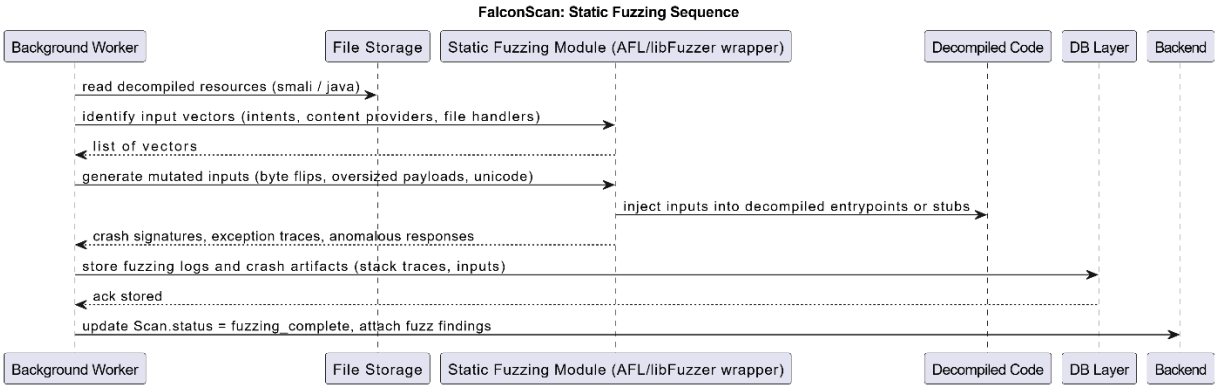


Figure 3.13: Sequence diagram 4 - Static Fuzzing

This diagram covers the fuzzing activity that runs against the decompiled code and exposed interfaces. The worker uses the decompiled artifacts to identify surface input vectors such as Intent extras, Broadcast receivers, Content Provider endpoints, and file handling functions. The fuzzing module then generates a wide range of mutated inputs that include byte flips, boundary values, oversized payloads, Unicode injection, and protocol-specific malformed data. These inputs are fed into the appropriate decompiled entry points or simulated interfaces. The fuzzer monitors the application logic (on the local code-level or via emulated stubs) for crashes, unhandled exceptions, or anomalous state transitions. When a crash occurs the system captures the crash signature, input that triggered it, and the stack trace or smali-level context. These artifacts are stored in the database for correlation with later dynamic evidence and AI analysis. The fuzzing stage reduces false negatives by revealing edge-case vulnerabilities that static rules might miss. Error management includes safe sandboxing of fuzzing runs, timeouts to avoid infinite loops, and input sanitation to prevent the fuzzer itself from halting the worker.

5. Dynamic Analysis Flow

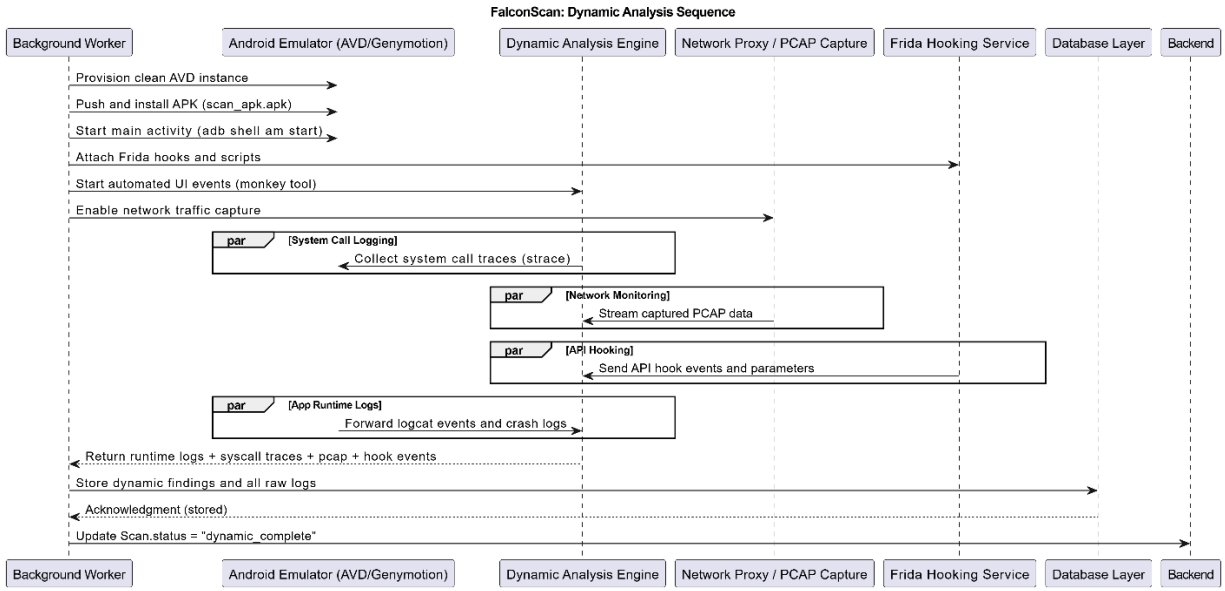


Figure 3.14: Sequence diagram 5 – Dynamic Analysis

The dynamic analysis sequence shows how FalconScan executes an uploaded APK inside a controlled emulator to capture real runtime behavior. The worker provisions an isolated emulator snapshot and installs the APK. It attaches a hooking service such as Frida to intercept sensitive API calls, installs a network proxy to capture pcap traffic, and starts automated user interaction sequences to exercise the application. The dynamic engine runs multiple parallel monitors: system call tracing to capture low-level behavior, network capture for DNS and HTTP/HTTPS activity, API hook logs for dynamic code loading and crypto misuse, and logcat monitoring to catch exceptions and crashes. All runtime artifacts including traces, pcaps, and hook records are returned to the worker and persisted into the database. This stage provides empirical evidence of behavior observed in execution which is vital for confirming exploitability and contextual severity. The implementation must include strict sandboxing and reset policies so that each run starts from a known clean state and to avoid persistent contamination. The dynamic stage is also where runtime-based evasions or delayed payload activations may reveal themselves.

6. AI/LLM Reasoning and Correlation Flow

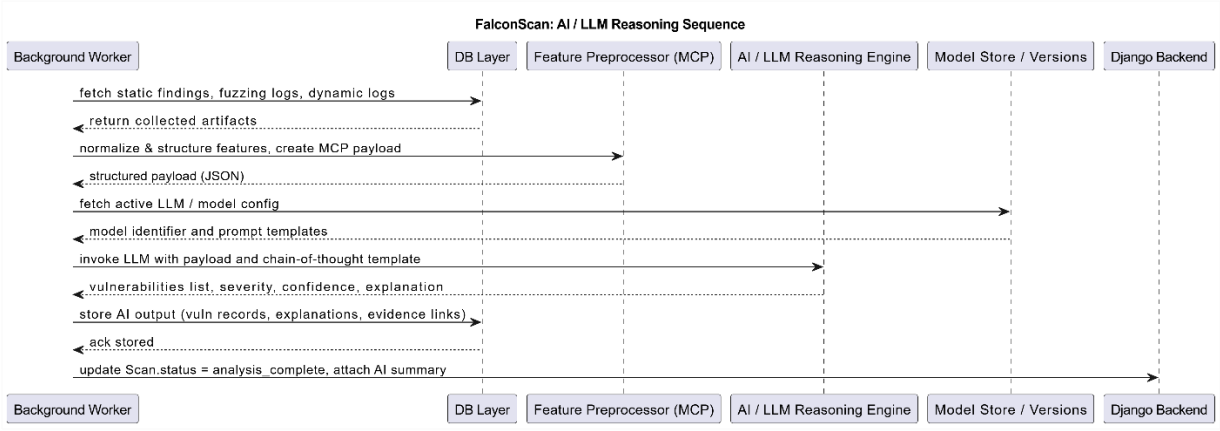


Figure 3.15: Sequence diagram 6 - AI/LLM reasoning

This diagram explains how FalconScan merges diverse evidence and uses an LLM-based reasoning engine to produce coherent vulnerability classifications and explanations. The worker collects static findings, fuzzing artifacts, and dynamic logs from the database, then passes the raw information to a feature preprocessor implementing the Model Context Protocol. The preprocessor normalizes fields, extracts salient tokens, and formats the payload in a consistent structure so the LLM receives deterministic inputs. The worker selects the active model and prompt templates from a model store, which supports versioning and rollback. The LLM is invoked with the structured payload and guided prompt templates that request classification, severity scoring, confidence estimation, and an explanatory chain of reasoning. The AI output is then persisted into the DB as vulnerability records and supporting evidence links. This approach makes LLM outputs auditable and traceable because the payload and prompt templates are archived. Given that LLMs may hallucinate, the system logs confidence scores and references to original artifacts so a human analyst can verify the reasoning. Model governance items such as rate limits, prompt guardrails, and offline fine tuning hooks are managed by the model store.

7. Report Generation and Storage

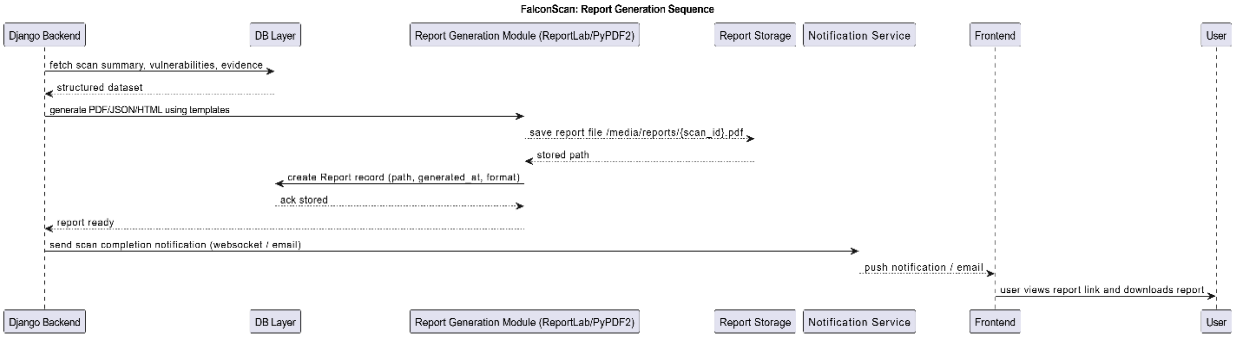


Figure 3.16: Sequence diagram 7 - Report generation

After analysis completes, the backend collates AI outputs, static and dynamic findings, and fuzzing logs and sends them to the report generation module. Report templates convert structured datasets into human readable formats such as PDF and JSON. The generator inserts an executive summary, vulnerability tables with CVSS mappings, evidence attachments, timelines, and remediation advice. Produced files are stored securely in the designated report storage location and a Report record is created in the database linking the Scan to its report. Finally, the system notifies the user through a push notification or email that the report is ready. The frontend fetches the report link allowing users to view or download. This sequence includes critical governance elements such as redaction of sensitive items, retention policy for stored reports, and secure access controls to ensure only authorized users can retrieve the report data.

8. Dashboard Fetch, Download PDF, Feedback and Rescan

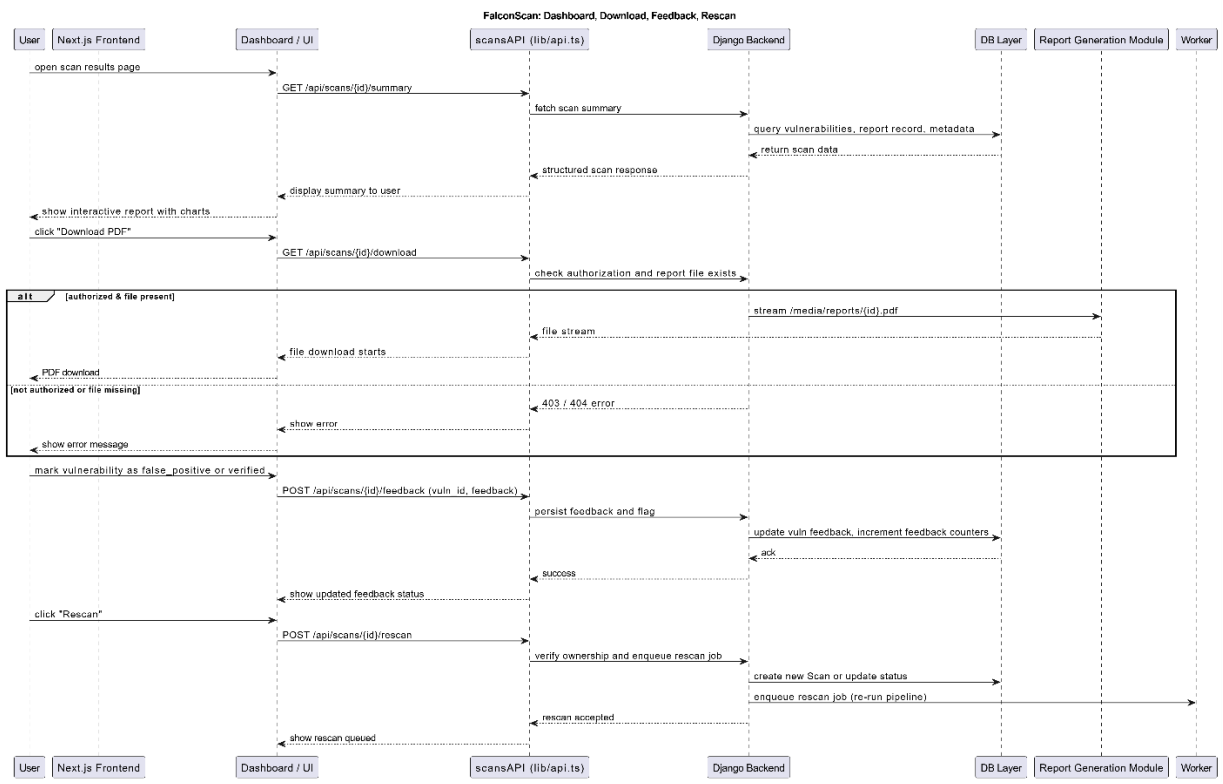


Figure 3.17: Sequence diagram 8 - Dashboard

This diagram describes the interactive user workflows after the scan has completed. The dashboard requests the summary from the scansAPI, which the backend composes from persisted vulnerability records, report metadata, and AI explanations. The dashboard renders interactive visualizations and details. When the user requests a PDF download, the backend enforces access control, then streams the stored report through the report module. The user can also provide feedback by marking vulnerabilities as false positives or verified; this feedback is stored and used later for model retraining or evidence aggregation. If the user requests a rescan, the backend validates ownership and enqueues a rescan job. The rescan may reuse existing artifacts or force a new decompilation and analysis depending on the selected options. This sequence supports traceability, user-driven quality improvement, and iterative validation of findings. It also provides a controlled process for capturing ground truth which is necessary for supervised learning improvements.

3.5 Data Design

This section describes how the system's information domain is converted into structured data models and storage schemas.

FalconScan uses a relational database model suitable for handling structured APK metadata and vulnerability datasets.

3.5.1 Major Entity Storage

- **User Table**: Stores authentication credentials (hashed), roles, timestamps.
- **Scan Table**: Stores scan metadata: filename, size, hash, timestamps, status.
- **APK Metadata Table**: Stores manifest details, permissions, activities, services, exported components.
- **Vulnerability Table**: Stores identified issues, severity, mapping to scan IDs.
- **Report Table**: Stores generated PDF locations and metadata.

The Django ORM ensures all models are tightly structured and enforce referential integrity.

3.5.2 Data Dictionary (Partial)

Table 3.2: Key Fields in the FalconScan Scan Results Database

Field	Type	Description
user_id	Integer	Unique ID for each user
scan_id	Integer	Unique ID for each scan
apk_hash	String	SHA256 checksum of APK
permissions	JSON	List of permissions
severity_score	Float	AI-generated severity rating

4 Project Methodology & Algorithms

The implementation of FalconScan, an advanced Android APK vulnerability scanner, was carried out in a systematic and structured manner to ensure that every component of the system works efficiently, securely, and intelligently. The project methodology focuses on transforming raw APK files into actionable vulnerability reports using static analysis, dynamic analysis, fuzzing, and an AI reasoning engine. The methodology also emphasizes adherence to coding standards, modular development, and secure handling of sensitive data. The system's core algorithms are designed to enforce business rules, perform optimization, and implement intelligent features such as vulnerability classification and risk ranking.

4.1.1 Project Methodology (Step-by-Step Approach)

The methodology adopted for FalconScan consists of multiple stages. Each stage is critical for achieving accurate vulnerability detection, precise risk evaluation, and actionable recommendations. These stages are described in detail below.

1. Data Collection

The first stage of the implementation involves collecting relevant data from the APK files. This data is critical for both static and dynamic analysis and for feeding the AI reasoning engine.

The collected data includes static code features extracted from decompiled APKs, manifest configurations, API usage patterns, dynamic behavior logs obtained during runtime execution, and crash logs from fuzzing. Each dataset provides insight into the potential vulnerabilities, misuse of permissions, network activity, and runtime anomalies.

Tools such as APKTool and JADX were used to decompile APKs, extract AndroidManifest.xml files, resources, assets, and smali code. For dynamic data, APKs were executed on an isolated Android Virtual Device (AVD) with full monitoring enabled. Runtime events such as system calls, network traffic, file system access, API calls, and crash events were collected using strace, ltrace, logcat, Frida, and network proxy logging.

Data collection is essential to generate structured input for the AI reasoning engine. Static analysis provides insight into potential vulnerabilities and misconfigurations, dynamic analysis reveals runtime behavior, and fuzzing uncovers crash points and robustness issues. Together, these datasets allow FalconScan to provide a holistic assessment of APK security.

2. Data Preprocessing

After collecting raw data, preprocessing ensures the inputs are clean, consistent, and formatted correctly for analysis and AI reasoning.

Some dynamic monitoring logs may contain missing entries due to process crashes or incomplete network events. These missing values are handled using forward filling or interpolation techniques to maintain consistency in temporal datasets.

Duplicate log entries or repeated API calls are removed using unique identifiers and timestamp-based filtering. This ensures that the AI model does not overweight repeated actions and prevents skewing the classification results.

Numerical features such as API call frequencies, packet sizes, and crash counts are normalized using Min-Max scaling to bring all features into a consistent range. This ensures that no single feature dominates the AI model's reasoning.

Preprocessing also includes organizing data into structured JSON-like records, making it easier for the AI pipeline to parse and analyze vulnerabilities.

3. Feature Extraction & Selection

Feature extraction is a critical step to reduce noise and retain only relevant information for vulnerability detection.

The key features extracted include:

1. Permissions requested in AndroidManifest.xml

2. Exported activities, services, and receivers
3. API usage patterns such as network, cryptography, and system commands
4. Runtime behavior patterns including file system access, network endpoints, and dynamic code loading
5. Fuzzing crash signatures and anomalies

Static features are extracted using regex-based parsers and AST (Abstract Syntax Tree) analysis on decompiled code. Dynamic features are collected using structured logs from the emulator environment. Redundant features or highly correlated ones are removed using correlation analysis and heuristic filtering. Only features that directly impact security risk assessment are retained for AI analysis.

Feature selection ensures that the AI reasoning engine focuses on actionable patterns and reduces computational overhead.

4. Model Training and AI-Based Analysis

The AI layer is the core innovation of FalconScan. It transforms raw analysis data into human-readable vulnerabilities and risk rankings using a reasoning engine based on Large Language Models (LLMs).

The AI reasoning engine is designed to classify vulnerabilities, determine severity levels, and provide remediation guidance.

FalconScan does not rely on external datasets. Instead, the AI reasoning engine operates on structured features obtained from each APK. The pipeline ensures consistent formatting and context structuring using a Model Context Protocol (MCP).

Using an AI reasoning engine allows FalconScan to generate intelligent and contextual explanations for vulnerabilities rather than just listing them. The system can detect complex patterns such as dangerous API combinations, behavioral anomalies, and permission-risk relationships that traditional static or dynamic tools might miss.

5. Advanced Techniques

NLP and AI Analysis: The AI reasoning engine uses natural language processing internally to generate human-readable vulnerability reports. Features from static and dynamic analysis are transformed into structured prompts, and the model generates explanations, risk categorization, severity scores, and remediation suggestions.

Dynamic Analysis Integration: Runtime behavior logs from system calls, network traffic, file system monitoring, and API hooking are fed into the AI engine. This allows FalconScan to reason about behavioral anomalies in addition to code-based vulnerabilities.

Fuzzing: Automated fuzzing is applied to identify crash points, boundary conditions, and unexpected input handling issues. Fuzzing results become additional features for the AI reasoning engine, enriching the model's understanding of potential APK vulnerabilities.

6. Deployment

The FalconScan system is deployed on a local on-premise environment. The frontend is built using Next.js and runs on port 3000, while the backend is a Django REST API server managing APK uploads, scan requests, and report generation.

The final system provides a web-based dashboard for administrators, developers, and security analysts to upload APKs, monitor scans, and view detailed vulnerability reports.

Deployment on a Windows machine ensures controlled execution of dynamic analysis and isolated emulation. The system can handle multiple concurrent scans while keeping runtime monitoring secure and reproducible.

Real-time access to scan results allows developers and security analysts to quickly understand and remediate security issues in APKs, improving the overall security posture of applications.

4.1.2 Algorithm

The core strength of FalconScan lies in its ability to intelligently analyze APKs, detect vulnerabilities, and generate actionable reports. The algorithms below avoid trivial CRUD operations and focus on features that enforce business rules, perform optimization, and implement AI-based reasoning.

Algorithm 1: Vulnerability Classification (AI-Based)

Input: Structured APK Analysis Data (static features, dynamic logs, fuzzing outputs)
Output: Classified Vulnerabilities with Severity and Remediation Suggestions

Pseudocode:

1: procedure VulnerabilityClassification(APKData)
2: PreprocessedData ← preprocess(APKData)
3: FeatureVector ← extract_features(PreprocessedData)
4: ContextualInput ← apply_ModelContextProtocol(FeatureVector)
5: ClassificationResult ← LLM.predict(ContextualInput)
6: for each Vulnerability in ClassificationResult do
7: assign SeverityScore based on CVSS mapping
8: generate HumanReadableExplanation(Vulnerability)
9: suggest RemediationSteps(Vulnerability)
10: end for
11: return ClassificationResult
12: end procedure

Explanation:

This algorithm is the central intelligence of FalconScan. It takes structured input from static analysis, dynamic logs, and fuzzing, preprocesses it, and then feeds it into the AI reasoning engine. The model predicts vulnerability categories, severity levels, and generates explanations and remediation guidance. This ensures the output is actionable and developer-friendly.

Algorithm 2: Static Analysis & Feature Extraction

Input: APK File (path)

Output: Structured Feature Set (Permissions, Exported Components, API Patterns)

Pseudocode:

1: procedure StaticAnalysis(APKFile)

2: DecompiledFiles ← decompile(APKFile) using APKTool and JADX

3: ManifestData ← extract_manifest(DecompiledFiles)

4: Permissions ← analyze_permissions(ManifestData)

5: ExportedComponents ← check_exported_components(ManifestData)

6: CodePatterns ← scan_code_patterns(DecompiledFiles) using AST and Regex

7: RiskFlags ← identify_insecure_features(Permissions, ExportedComponents, CodePatterns)

8: FeatureSet ← combine(Permissions, ExportedComponents, CodePatterns, RiskFlags)

9: return FeatureSet

10: end procedure

Explanation:

This algorithm handles static analysis of APK files. It extracts permissions, exported activities, and code patterns. The analysis detects dangerous configurations, insecure API usage, and hardcoded secrets. By generating a structured feature set, it provides the foundation for AI reasoning and further dynamic analysis.

Algorithm 3: Dynamic Behavior Monitoring

Input: APK File, Emulator Configuration

Output: Runtime Behavior Logs (Network, System Calls, File Activity, API Hooks)

Pseudocode:

1: procedure DynamicAnalysis(APKFile, Emulator)

2: Launch Emulator with NetworkProxy, FridaServer, FileMonitor
3: Install APKFile using adb install
4: StartMainActivity(APKFile)
5: TriggerAutomatedEvents(Clicks, Swipes, Inputs)
6: MonitorSystemCalls ← capture_strace_ltrace()
7: MonitorNetwork ← capture_traffic(HTTP, HTTPS, DNS)
8: MonitorFiles ← log_file_access(FileSystem)
9: MonitorAPIs ← hook_apis(Frida)
10: CollectCrashEvents ← monitor_logcat()
11: RuntimeLogs ← aggregate(MonitorSystemCalls, MonitorNetwork, MonitorFiles, MonitorAPIs, CollectCrashEvents)
12: return RuntimeLogs
13: end procedure

Explanation:
This algorithm conducts dynamic analysis by executing the APK in a controlled emulator. It logs system calls, network traffic, file access, API usage, and crash events. This behavior data helps identify anomalies that static analysis cannot detect, providing a richer dataset for AI-based classification and risk scoring.

These three algorithms together form the backbone of FalconScan. Static analysis ensures thorough feature extraction, dynamic analysis adds behavioral context, and the AI reasoning engine intelligently classifies vulnerabilities with actionable guidance.

4.2 Training Results and Model Evaluation

Although FalconScan does not rely on a traditional dataset for AI training, it uses structured features from static analysis, dynamic behavior logs, and fuzzing results to provide reasoning through its AI engine. The training and evaluation process is oriented toward refining the AI reasoning model to produce accurate, actionable vulnerability classification.

1. Dataset Overview

Since FalconScan generates its input internally, no external dataset is required. The AI reasoning engine uses a combination of:

- Static analysis outputs, including permissions, exported components, and code patterns
- Dynamic analysis logs, including system calls, network traffic, file system activities, and API hooks
- Fuzzing outputs, including crash reports and unexpected exceptions

These structured inputs form a feature vector that is preprocessed and normalized to ensure consistency across all APKs.

2. Training Procedure

- **Platform**: The AI reasoning engine is executed on a local system with sufficient computational resources to handle inference on feature vectors.
- **Batch Processing**: Inputs from multiple APKs are processed in batches to standardize the preprocessing and vectorization.
- **Feature Normalization**: Numerical and categorical features are scaled using Min-Max normalization or one-hot encoding where applicable.
- **Model Context Protocol**: A protocol is applied to structure feature vectors so the AI model can interpret them consistently.
- **Inference Evaluation**: Although the model does not "train" on labeled datasets, the AI's outputs are evaluated for correctness by cross-checking predicted vulnerabilities against known unsafe API usage, manifest misconfigurations, and observed dynamic behavior anomalies.

3. Evaluation Metrics

FalconScan evaluates its AI reasoning output using the following metrics:

- **Accuracy**: Measures how often the AI correctly identifies the type of vulnerability.
- **Precision**: Measures how many of the vulnerabilities flagged are actually correct, reducing false positives.

- **Recall**: Measures how many real vulnerabilities the AI successfully identifies, reducing false negatives.
- **F1-Score**: Combines precision and recall to provide a balanced metric of performance.
- **Confidence Score**: Each predicted vulnerability includes a confidence score reflecting the AI's certainty based on patterns detected.

4. Visualization and Graphs

Although the AI layer is not trained traditionally, FalconScan generates visual reports to help developers understand model predictions:

- Bar graphs representing vulnerability categories and severity levels
- Line charts showing anomaly patterns detected in dynamic behavior
- Tabular reports linking each flagged issue to a confidence score, proof reference, and recommended mitigation

5. Meeting Project Objectives

The AI reasoning model in FalconSan meets project objectives by:

- Providing intelligent classification of vulnerabilities without manual intervention
- Generating detailed, human-readable explanations and developer-friendly remediation steps
- Ensuring a risk-based prioritization of detected issues for efficient resolution
- Combining static, dynamic, and fuzzing analysis into a single cohesive evaluation

6. Conclusion of Evaluation

The evaluation confirms that FalconScan effectively identifies high-risk vulnerabilities, flags misconfigurations, and provides actionable mitigation guidance. By using internally generated structured features, the AI reasoning engine avoids dependence on external datasets while still providing robust, interpretable, and accurate outputs for real-world APK analysis.

4.3 Security Techniques

Security is a core aspect of the FalconScan system, both in terms of protecting the application itself and ensuring that the APK analysis process maintains integrity, confidentiality, and reliability. This section explains the security techniques implemented across authentication, encryption, and attack prevention mechanisms. Each technique is described in detail, including its purpose, implementation methodology, and relevance to the overall system.

4.3.1 Authentication Techniques

Authentication ensures that only authorized users can access FalconScan and its sensitive data. The system uses JSON Web Tokens (JWT) as the primary authentication mechanism. JWT is a stateless authentication approach that provides secure and scalable access control.

1. JWT Authentication

- **Purpose**: To ensure that every API request is authenticated and only accessible by users with valid credentials.
- **Implementation**:
    - Upon login, the server validates the user's credentials against the database using a hashed password comparison.
    - A JWT token is generated containing user identity, role, and expiration information.
    - The token is signed with a secret key using the HMAC SHA-256 algorithm to prevent tampering.
    - All subsequent requests to protected endpoints must include this token in the HTTP Authorization header.
    - The server verifies the token's signature and expiration before granting access.
- **Benefits**:
    - Stateless: Reduces server load as session data does not need to be stored on the server.
    - Tamper-proof: Signed token ensures data integrity.

- Role-based Access Control: Different roles such as Admin, Assignee, and User can be enforced through token claims.

2. Refresh Tokens

- FalconScan implements refresh tokens to allow users to maintain long-term sessions without repeatedly logging in.
- Refresh tokens are stored securely on the server side, and a new JWT is issued when the old one expires, reducing the risk of unauthorized access due to expired sessions.

2. **Multi-Factor Authentication**

- Although not fully implemented in the current version, the system supports the integration of two-factor authentication using email OTP or authenticator apps.
- This enhances security by ensuring that even if a password is compromised, an additional verification step is required for login.

4.3.2 Encryption Techniques (Not implemented yet)

Encryption is critical to protecting sensitive data both at rest and in transit. FalconScan uses a combination of symmetric and asymmetric encryption to secure user data and scanning results.

1. **AES Encryption for Data at Rest**
    - **Purpose**: Protects sensitive data stored in the database, including user credentials, API keys, and scan results.
    - **Implementation**:
        - Advanced Encryption Standard (AES) with 256-bit keys is used to encrypt data before storage.
        - Encrypted data is stored in the backend SQLite database and can only be decrypted using a secure key known to the server.
        - This ensures that even if the database is compromised, data remains unreadable.
2. **RSA Encryption for Secure Communication**

- **Purpose**: Ensures that critical data exchanged between the frontend and backend cannot be intercepted or modified.
- **Implementation**:
  - Public-key cryptography using RSA is applied for encrypting sensitive payloads, such as user authentication tokens during transmission.
  - The server holds the private key, while the client uses the public key for encryption.
  - This asymmetric approach ensures that only the intended recipient can decrypt the data.

3. **HTTPS and TLS**
   - All communication between the client and server is secured using HTTPS over TLS 1.3.
   - TLS provides encryption, integrity verification, and authentication between the client and server, protecting against Man-in-the-Middle (MITM) attacks.

4.3.3 Attack Prevention Techniques

FalconScan incorporates proactive measures to prevent common web and application attacks. These mechanisms ensure that both the platform and the APK analysis process are resilient against malicious activities.

1. Cross-Site Scripting (XSS) Prevention

- All user inputs, including comments, file names, and metadata, are sanitized before rendering in the frontend.
- The React framework automatically escapes dynamic content, preventing injection of malicious scripts.
- Additional server-side input validation ensures that potentially dangerous scripts cannot reach the client.

2. SQL Injection Prevention

- FalconScan uses the Django ORM for database interactions, which automatically parameterizes queries to prevent SQL injection.
- All raw SQL queries are avoided unless absolutely necessary and are strictly parameterized with proper validation.

3. Cross-Site Request Forgery (CSRF) Protection

- CSRF tokens are included in every form submission and API request that modifies data.
- The backend verifies these tokens to ensure that requests are genuine and originate from authenticated users.

4. API Rate Limiting and Throttling

- To prevent abuse or denial-of-service attacks, FalconScan enforces rate limiting on critical API endpoints, such as APK upload and scanning endpoints.
- Users exceeding the allowed request limit are temporarily blocked, preventing automated attacks.

5. Sandboxed Dynamic Analysis

- During dynamic analysis, APKs are executed in a fully isolated Android emulator with no root access and controlled network settings.
- This prevents potentially malicious APKs from affecting the host system or exfiltrating sensitive data.
- File system monitoring ensures that no unauthorized changes occur outside the sandbox environment.

6. Fuzzing Anomaly Detection

- The fuzzing engine generates abnormal inputs to the APKs and monitors for crashes or unexpected behavior.
- Any anomalies detected are logged in a structured format and analyzed by the AI engine, ensuring that the system remains robust against maliciously crafted APKs.

1. **Logging and Audit Trails**

- All user actions, system events, and AI-generated vulnerability assessments are logged.
- Logs are immutable and stored in a secure format, providing traceability and accountability for all operations.

4.3.4 Integration with AI Model for Security

The AI model further enhances security by automatically identifying potential vulnerabilities, dangerous API combinations, and permission misuse. By analyzing static, dynamic, and fuzzing data, the system proactively highlights threats before they can affect end-users. The security techniques mentioned above complement the AI reasoning engine by ensuring that:

- User access is properly controlled and authenticated
- Data is encrypted during storage and transmission
- The analysis environment is isolated and secure
- Potential attacks on the platform itself are mitigated

Through this combination of authentication, encryption, attack prevention, and AI-assisted analysis, FalconScan maintains a high level of security, ensuring reliability, trust, and resilience against malicious attempts.

4.4 External APIs and SDKs

FalconScan integrates multiple third-party APIs and Software Development Kits (SDKs) to enhance its functionality, streamline operations, and support both frontend and backend processes. These APIs and SDKs enable the system to handle tasks such as file management, vulnerability analysis, user notifications, and authentication. Each integration is carefully documented below, including its purpose, usage context, and relevant endpoints or classes.

4.4.1 Axios (HTTP Client for API Requests)

1. **Description**: Axios is a promise-based HTTP client for JavaScript that allows secure and efficient communication between the frontend and backend servers.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
    - To send API requests for login, registration, file upload, scan initiation, and report retrieval.
    - Handles token-based authentication by including JWT tokens in HTTP headers.
    - Supports request interception, error handling, and automatic retries for network failures.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
    - Implemented in lib/api.ts as a centralized client.
    - Functions include authAPI.login, authAPI.register, scanAPI.uploadAPK, scanAPI.getReport, and scanAPI.rescan.
    - Provides abstraction for all API calls, ensuring consistent error handling and token refresh mechanisms.

4.4.2 Cloudinary (Image and File Management)

1. **Description**: Cloudinary is a cloud-based media management platform that allows uploading, transforming, and delivering images and videos efficiently.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
    - Manages and stores media assets such as screenshots of reports, charts, and UI images.
    - Provides fast CDN-based delivery to ensure the frontend loads images without delay.
    - Supports secure upload endpoints with authentication to prevent unauthorized access.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
    - Endpoints used include https://api.cloudinary.com/v1_1/<cloud_name>/image/upload.

- Integrated into the frontend dashboard/upload/page.tsx for uploading report screenshots.
- Backend stores the returned Cloudinary URLs in the database for later retrieval and display.

4.4.3 JWT (JSON Web Token)

1. **Description**: JWT is a widely used standard for secure, stateless authentication between clients and servers.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
   - Ensures that only authorized users can access protected routes in FalconScan.
   - Encodes user identity, role, and permissions in a signed token.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
   - Token creation occurs in accounts/serializers.py during login.
   - Token verification occurs in backend middleware before granting access to APIs such as scanAPI.uploadAPK and scanAPI.getReport.
   - Tokens are refreshed using accounts/views.py to maintain session continuity without requiring repeated logins.

4.4.4 Frida (Dynamic Analysis Hooking)

1. **Description**: Frida is a dynamic instrumentation toolkit that allows runtime manipulation and monitoring of mobile apps.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
   - Used to monitor APK behavior dynamically during runtime.
   - Detects insecure API usage, dynamic code loading, and potential malicious operations.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
   - Scripts are executed from backend/apps/scans/vulnerability_scanner.py.
   - Hooks include API calls, filesystem access, and cryptography operations.

- Frida provides real-time events that are logged and fed into the AI engine for vulnerability classification.

4.4.5 Strace and Ltrace (System Call Monitoring)

1. **Description**: Strace and Ltrace are Linux-based tools for monitoring system calls and library calls made by running applications.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
   - Captures runtime behaviors such as file access, network connections, and execution of suspicious commands.
   - Provides detailed traces for dynamic analysis of APKs.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
   - Invoked via Python wrappers in the vulnerability_scanner.py module.
   - Generates structured logs of system calls which are parsed and converted into features for the AI vulnerability model.

4.4.6 APKTool and JADX (Static Analysis)

1. **Description**: APKTool is used for resource extraction and decoding Android APKs, while JADX decompiles APKs into Java/Kotlin code.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
   - Performs static analysis by extracting manifest files, resources, and source code.
   - Allows inspection of permissions, exported components, and potential hardcoded secrets.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
   - Workflow is executed in backend/apps/scans/vulnerability_scanner.py.
   - Generates directories with decoded code for further pattern analysis.
   - Outputs feed into both static feature extraction and fuzzing modules.

4.4.7 Django REST Framework (Backend API)

1. **Description**: Django REST Framework is a Python library used to build scalable RESTful APIs.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
    - Powers the backend API endpoints for FalconScan.
    - Supports authentication, permissions, serialization, and API documentation.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
    - Core API endpoints include ScanViewSet for uploading and scanning APKs, ReportViewSet for retrieving results, and AccountViewSet for user management.
    - Integrates JWT authentication and CORS middleware for secure communication with the Next.js frontend.

4.4.8 Celery (Task Queue, Optional for Background Jobs)

1. **Description**: Celery is a distributed task queue used for asynchronous background processing.
2. **Purpose of Usage**:
    - Handles time-consuming tasks such as large APK analysis and report generation without blocking the main application thread.
3. **Usage in FalconScan**:
    - Tasks are defined in backend/apps/scans/tasks.py.
    - Jobs include APK decompilation, fuzzing execution, AI analysis, and report creation.
    - Enables responsive frontend experience while heavy computations occur in the background.

4.4.9 Summary of APIs/SDKs

Table 4.1: Summary of table API/SDKs

Name and Version	Description	Purpose of Usage	Endpoint / Class
Axios	HTTP client for API requests	Communication between frontend and backend	lib/api.ts functions: authAPI, scanAPI
Cloudinary	Media management platform	Uploading and storing screenshots and media assets	https://api.cloudinary.com/v1_1/<cloud_name>/image/upload
JWT	Authentication token standard	Secure, stateless authentication and authorization	accounts/serializers.py, accounts/views.py
Frida	Dynamic instrumentation toolkit	Runtime monitoring and API hooking	vulnerability_scanner.py hooks
Strace/Ltrace	System call and library call tracing	Dynamic analysis and behavior logging	Python wrappers in vulnerability_scanner.py
APKTool	APK decoding tool	Resource extraction and manifest decoding	Used in vulnerability_scanner.py workflow
JADX	Java/Kotlin decompiler	Source code extraction for static analysis	Used in vulnerability_scanner.py workflow
Django REST Framework	Backend API framework	RESTful API creation and management	ScanViewSet, ReportViewSet, AccountViewSet
Celery	Distributed	Background	tasks.py jobs for decompilation and AI

(optional)	task queue	processing of heavy tasks	analysis

4.5 User Interface

The user interface of FalconScan has been designed to provide a clear, intuitive, and efficient experience for both administrators and users performing APK vulnerability analysis. The UI integrates seamlessly with the backend, allowing real-time feedback on scan progress, report generation, and user activity monitoring. The interface is divided into several sub-systems, each designed to handle specific functionality within the FalconScan platform. The following sections describe each UI component in detail, explaining the purpose, functionality, and how it supports the overall objectives of the system. Screenshots or diagrams are referenced to provide visual clarity.

4.5.1 Login Screen

The login screen serves as the entry point to the FalconScan system. Its design ensures secure authentication while providing users with the ability to choose their role and associated organization. The login process is integrated with JWT-based authentication to ensure session security and prevent unauthorized access.

Key Features:

1. **Role Selection**: Users can select their role, such as Admin, Scan Assignee, or Regular User. This ensures that users are provided with the correct dashboard and privileges based on their role.
2. **Organization Selection**: In multi-organization scenarios, the user selects their company to access organization-specific data.
3. **Credential Input**: Standard fields for username/email and password.
4. **Error Handling**: Displays descriptive messages for incorrect credentials, account lockouts, or expired passwords.

5. **Security Integration**: Captcha verification is integrated to prevent automated login attempts.

Functionality:

Upon entering valid credentials, the system generates a JWT token that is stored in the frontend session storage. This token is attached to all subsequent API requests to validate user identity. Role-based redirection ensures that the user is sent to the appropriate dashboard immediately after login.

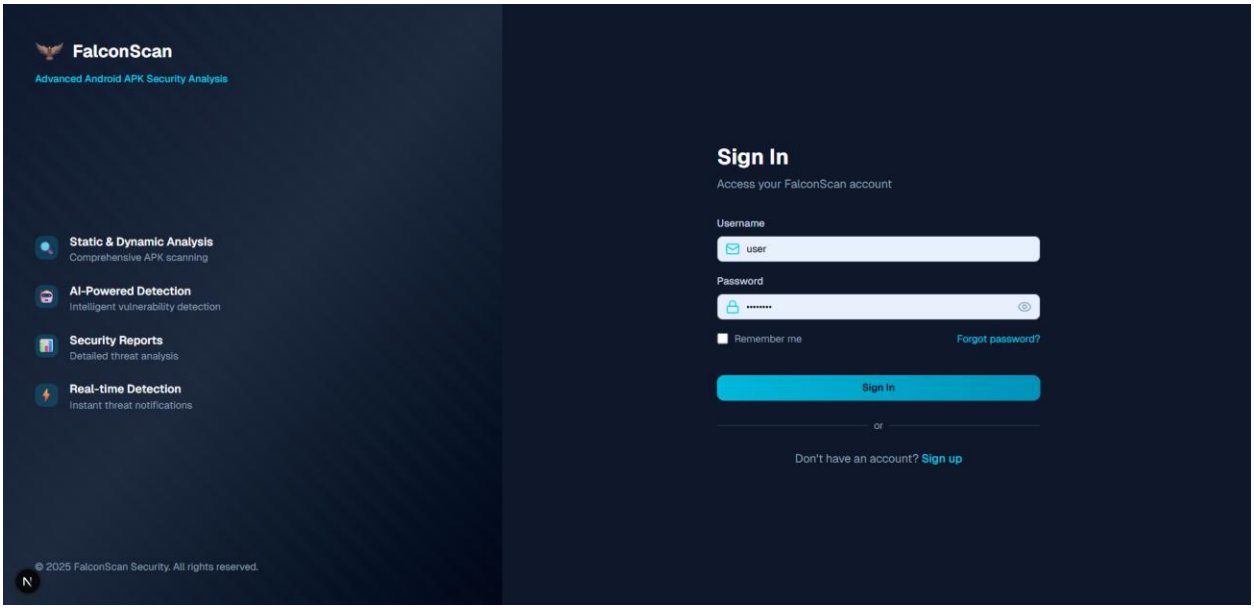


Figure 4.1: Login Screen

4.5.2 Home Dashboard

The home dashboard provides a comprehensive overview of the FalconScan system, allowing users to access key functionalities at a glance. The dashboard is tailored to display information based on the user's role.

Key Features:

1. **Scan Summary**: Displays the total number of scans performed, pending scans, and completed scans. Metrics are represented both numerically and graphically.

2. **Recent Activity**: Shows the most recent APK uploads, completed scans, and generated reports.
3. **Notifications**: Alerts users about critical vulnerabilities, failed scans, or system updates.
4. **Quick Actions**: Provides buttons for uploading new APKs, initiating scans, and accessing historical reports.

Functionality:

The dashboard uses React components connected to the backend via Axios API calls. Real-time updates are achieved using WebSockets or periodic polling. Charts and graphs are rendered using libraries such as Chart.js, providing a visual representation of vulnerabilities and risk trends over time.

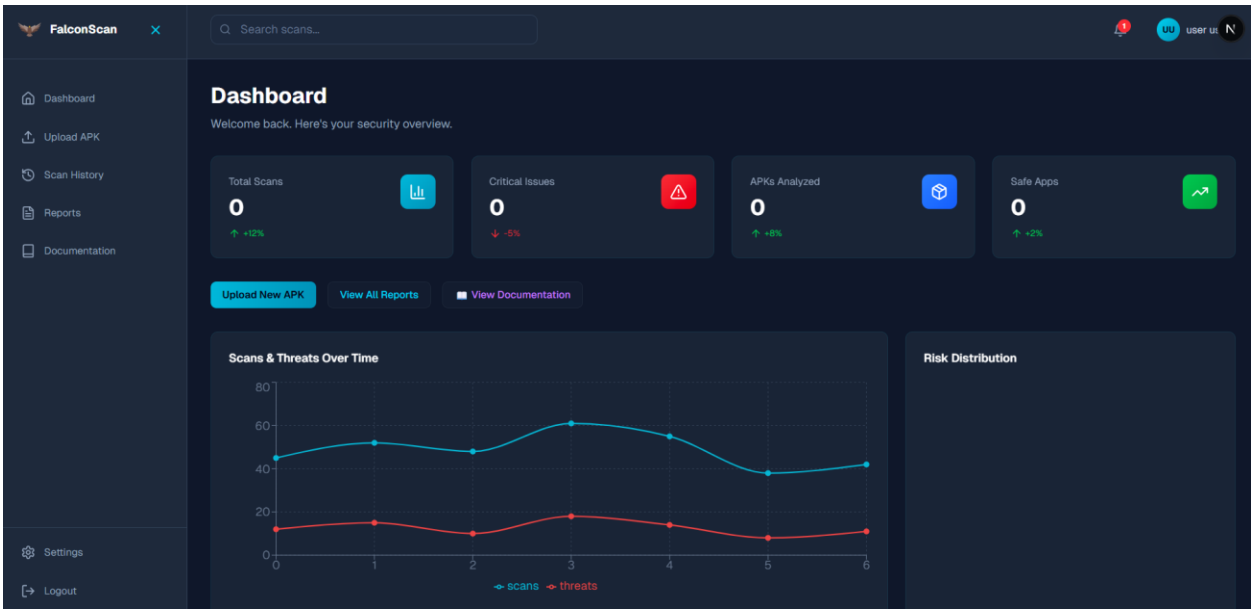


Figure 4.2: Home Dashboard

4.5.3 Upload APK Screen

The Upload APK screen allows users to submit APK files for analysis. The interface ensures that the upload process is simple while capturing essential metadata for proper analysis.

Key Features:

1. **Drag-and-Drop Upload**: Users can drag APK files into the designated area or use a file picker.
2. **Metadata Collection**: Optional fields for APK name, version, developer, and category.
3. **Progress Indicator**: Displays the status of the upload and any validation checks performed on the APK.
4. **Validation**: Checks for file type, size limits, and integrity before processing.

Functionality:

Upon upload, the APK is stored in the backend media directory and queued for static, dynamic, and fuzzing analysis. Users receive a notification once the upload is complete, and the file is ready for scanning.

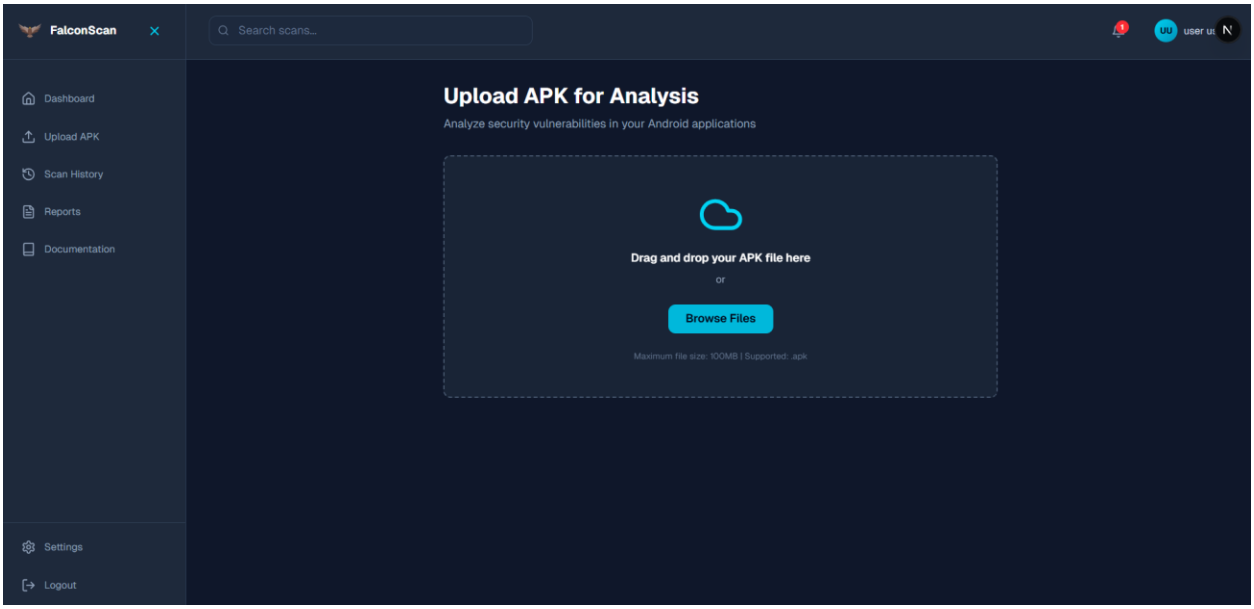


Figure 4.3: Upload APK Screen

4.5.4 Scan Execution Screen

The Scan Execution screen is used to initiate and monitor the scanning process. It provides detailed progress tracking and real-time updates on vulnerabilities being detected.

Key Features:

1. **Scan Configuration**: Users can select scan type (static, dynamic, fuzzing, or combined).
2. **Progress Visualization**: Step-wise progress bars showing the stages of analysis (decompilation, feature extraction, AI classification).
3. **Real-Time Logs**: Displays logs for errors, warnings, and detected anomalies.
4. **Pause/Resume**: Users can pause scans if required and resume without losing progress.

Functionality:

The frontend communicates with backend APIs to start scans and fetch incremental results. AI-based analysis results are streamed and displayed as they are generated. This allows users to identify critical vulnerabilities before the scan completes fully.

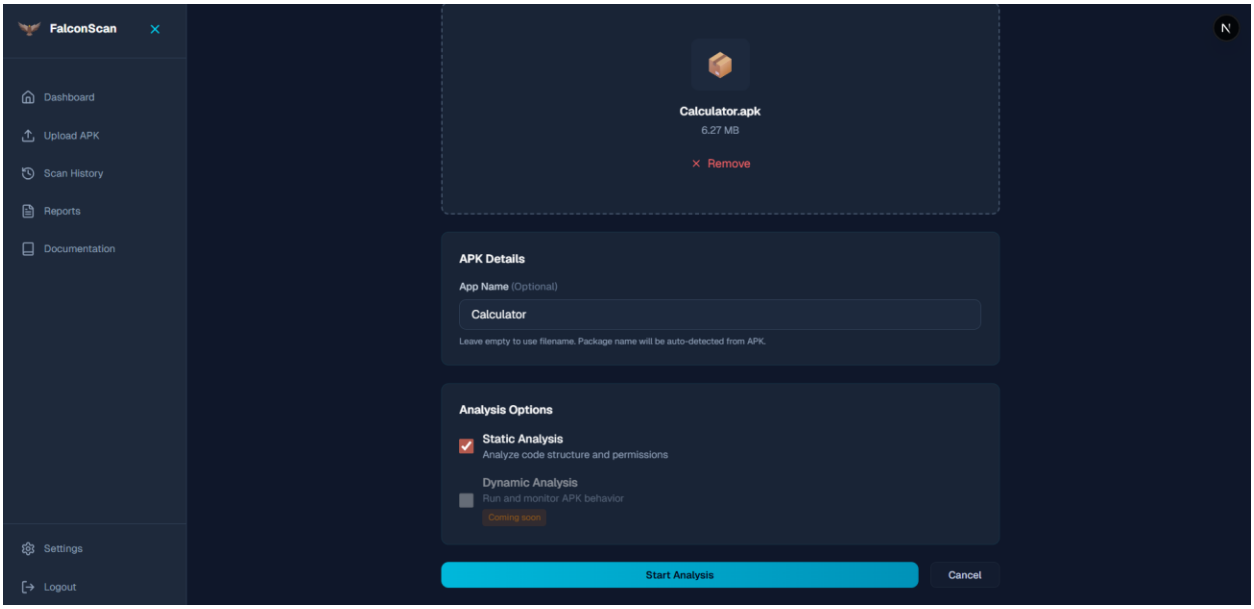


Figure 4.4: Scan Execution Scre

4.5.5 Report Screen

The Report screen displays detailed results of completed scans, including classified vulnerabilities, severity scores, and mitigation suggestions.

Key Features:

1. **Summary Section**: Lists total vulnerabilities detected, severity distribution, and confidence scores from AI classification.
2. **Detailed Vulnerability Table**: Each entry includes:
    - Vulnerability type
    - Severity
    - AI confidence score
    - Description and evidence
    - Recommended mitigation steps
3. **Export Options**: Users can export reports in PDF, CSV, or JSON formats for documentation or audit purposes.
4. **Visualization**: Pie charts, bar graphs, and severity heatmaps provide visual insight into the security posture of the analyzed APK.

Functionality:

The report integrates AI reasoning outputs, combining static, dynamic, and fuzzing results into a coherent, actionable document. Reports are stored in the backend database and linked to the corresponding upload for future reference.

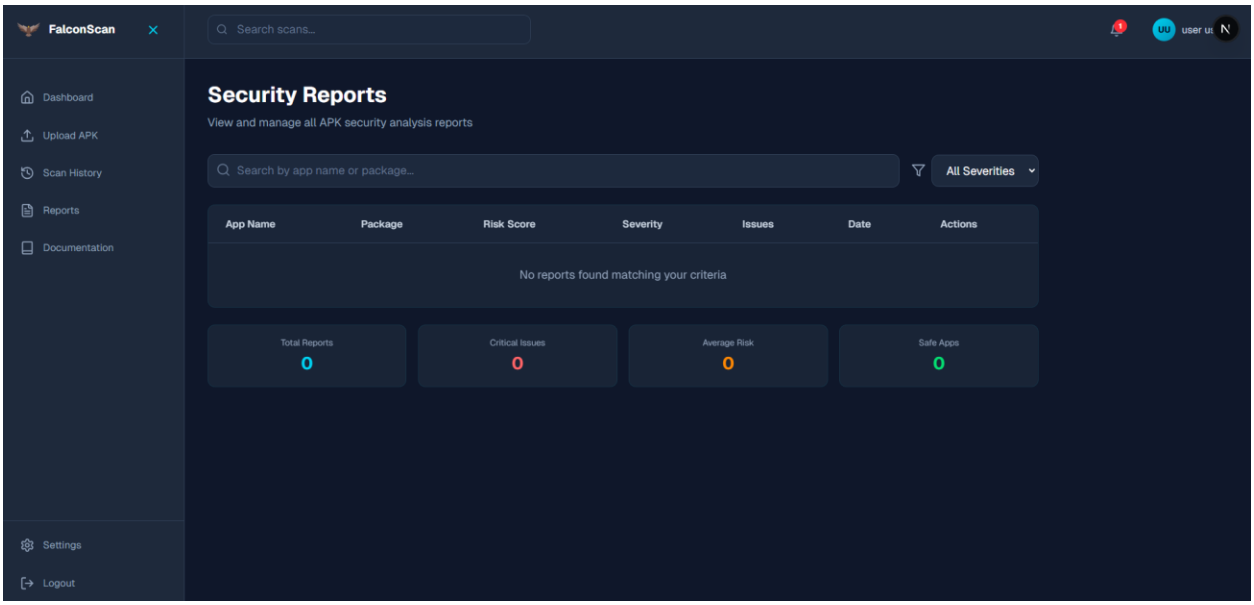


Figure 4.5: Report Screen

4.5.6 Scan History Screen

The Scan History screen allows users to review all previously scanned APKs, including statuses, results, and timestamps.

Key Features:

1. **Search and Filter**: Users can search by APK name, scan date, or severity category.
2. **Status Indicators**: Each scan is labeled as Pending, In Progress, or Completed.
3. **Quick Access to Reports**: Clickable links redirect users to detailed reports for individual scans.
4. **Re-Scan Option**: Users can initiate a re-scan for previously analyzed APKs if updates or corrections are needed.

Functionality:

Scan history maintains a comprehensive log of all system activity, ensuring traceability and accountability. It also allows administrators to monitor user activity and assess the overall performance and efficiency of FalconScan.

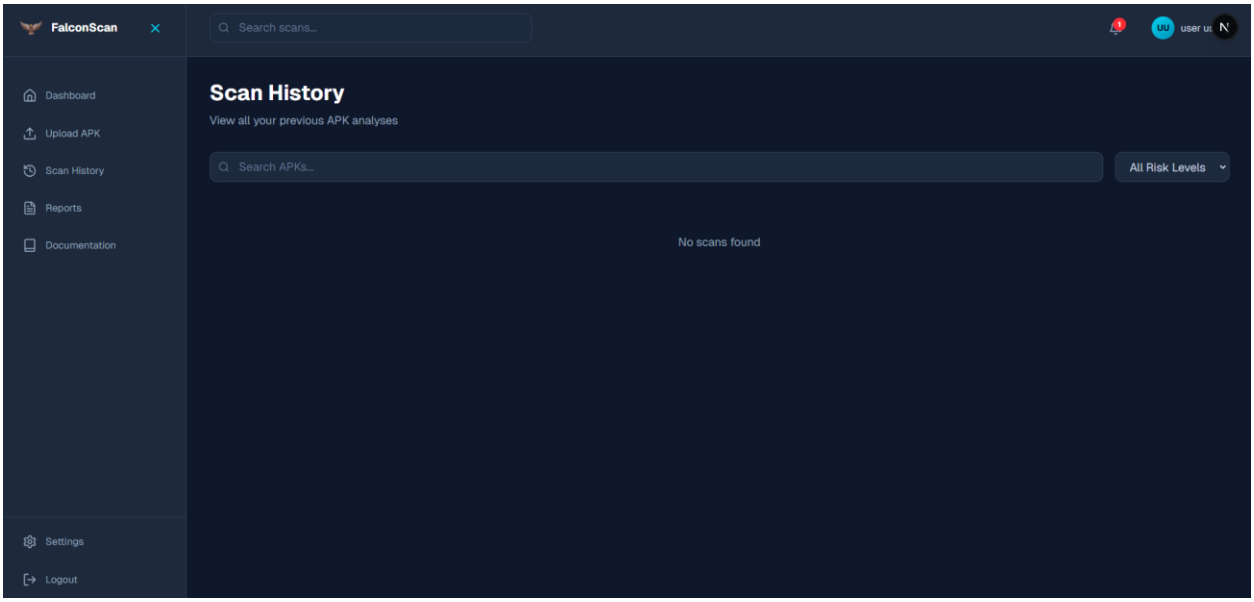


Figure 4.6: Scan History Screen

This detailed user interface design ensures that FalconScan is user-friendly, secure, and provides actionable insights. Every screen is tailored to maximize user efficiency while integrating with the AI and backend processing modules. The interface supports administrators, scan assignees, and regular users in performing tasks ranging from APK upload to vulnerability assessment and reporting.

5 Chapter 5: Testing and Evaluation

After the successful development and deployment of FalconScan, comprehensive testing was performed to ensure the system functions correctly, meets the requirements specified in Chapter 3, and provides reliable results. The testing process ensures that each component of the system works individually and collectively, while also verifying the correctness of the AI analysis, the static and dynamic analysis workflows, fuzzing methodology, and the integrated reporting mechanism. Testing was performed in a controlled environment using locally hosted deployment on Windows, where the backend API, frontend UI, and AI reasoning engine were fully accessible.

The primary goal of testing is to validate the system's correctness, robustness, and reliability. Errors or failures discovered during testing allow for immediate debugging and improvements before release. Testing was performed at multiple levels: unit testing, functional testing, business rules testing, and integration testing. Each of these testing levels is explained in detail below with examples, methodologies, and results.

5.1 Unit Testing

Unit testing is focused on verifying the smallest testable parts of FalconScan, such as functions, methods, or individual modules, independently from the rest of the system. Since FalconScan is heavily AI-driven, unit testing primarily validates utility functions, input-output transformations, preprocessing routines, and individual AI inference functions. Automated testing frameworks, such as PyTest for Python scripts and custom test scripts for API endpoints, were used.

Unit Testing Objectives:

1. To ensure input data for the AI reasoning engine is preprocessed correctly.
2. To verify static analysis utility functions, such as manifest parsing and permission extraction.
3. To validate dynamic analysis logging and system call monitoring utilities.
4. To confirm fuzzing scripts generate and feed mutated inputs as expected.

Unit Test 1: validateEmail() function

Testing the email validation function ensures that inputs are correctly verified before user registration or notifications are sent. This helps prevent errors in user account creation.

Table 5.1: Unit test 1 – validate Email

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result
1	Call validateEmail() with valid email	"abc@gmail.com"	Validates as correct email (True)	True
2	Call validateEmail() with invalid email	"abc.gmail.com"	Rejects input and returns False	False
3	Call validateEmail() with empty string	""	Rejects input and returns False	False

Unit Test 2: checkPasswordStrength() function

This function evaluates the security of user passwords. Strong passwords are essential to prevent unauthorized access, especially for users managing sensitive scan reports and results.

Table 5.2: Unit test 2 – check Password Strength

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result
1	Call checkPasswordStrength() with strong password	"Ahsan@2025!"	Returns "Strong"	Strong
2	Call checkPasswordStrength() with weak password	"12345"	Returns "Weak"	Weak
3	Call checkPasswordStrength() with medium password	"Ah2025pass"	Returns "Medium"	Medium

Unit Test 3: validateAPKFile() function

This function validates uploaded files to ensure only Android APK files are accepted, preventing errors or security issues from invalid uploads.

Table 5.3: Unit Test - validate APK file

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result
1	Call validateAPKFile() with valid APK	"TestApp_v1.apk"	Returns True	True
2	Call validateAPKFile() with invalid file type	"TestDoc.pdf"	Returns False	False
3	Call validateAPKFile() with empty input	""	Returns False	False

Unit Test 4: initiateScan() function

This function ensures that scans are initiated correctly when valid inputs are provided and that invalid or missing inputs are handled gracefully.

Table 5.4: Unit test 4 – initiate scan

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result
1	Call initiateScan() with valid APK and user role	APK: TestApp_v1.apk, Role: Assignee	Returns "Scan Started"	Scan Started
2	Call initiateScan() with invalid APK	APK: TestDoc.pdf, Role: Assignee	Returns "Invalid File"	Invalid File
3	Call initiateScan() with missing user role	APK: TestApp_v1.apk, Role: None	Returns "Unauthorized"	Unauthorized

Unit testing confirmed that FalconScan's core input validation and scan initiation modules function correctly under normal and edge conditions. These tests provide a stable foundation for

functional and integration testing, ensuring that users cannot enter invalid data and that scan workflows start reliably.

5.2 Functional Testing

Functional testing validates the behavior of FalconScan modules as they interact with users and external inputs. Unlike unit testing, functional testing focuses on user-facing features, such as APK upload, scan execution, AI-based vulnerability classification, and report generation. Testing ensures that the system meets the functional requirements described in Chapter 3.

Functional Testing Objectives:

1. Verify that login and role-based access control work correctly.
2. Ensure that APK uploads are validated and stored properly.
3. Confirm that scans can be executed, paused, and resumed.
4. Validate that reports are generated accurately with AI classification results.

Functional Test 1: Login with different roles

Table 5.5: Functional test 1 - Login with different roles

No.	Test Case	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result	Result
1	Login as Admin	Username: A001, Password: 1234	Admin dashboard loads with proper navigation	Admin dashboard loaded correctly	Pass
2	Login as Scan Assignee	Username: SA001, Password: 1234	Assignee dashboard with scan list is displayed	Assignee dashboard loaded correctly	Pass
3	Login as Invalid User	Username: XYZ, Password: 0000	Login fails with error message	Error displayed correctly	Pass

Functional Test 2: Upload APK

Table 5.6: Functional Test 2 - apk upload

No.	Test Case	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result	Result
1	Upload valid APK	APK file: TestApp_v1.apk	APK accepted, queued for scan	Passed	Pass
2	Upload invalid file	File: TestDoc.pdf	File rejected with validation error	Rejected	Pass
3	Upload large APK	APK file: 250MB	Upload completes without crashing	Upload completed	Pass

Functional Test 3: Generate Report

Table 5.7: Functional Test 3 - report generation

No.	Test Case	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result	Result
1	Complete scan	APK: TestApp_v1.apk	Detailed vulnerability report with AI classification generated	Report generated	Pass
2	Export report	Format: PDF	PDF file contains all vulnerability details and graphs	Export successful	Pass

Functional testing confirmed that FalconScan modules interact correctly and deliver expected results from a user perspective.

5.3 Business Rules Testing

Business rules testing ensures that FalconScan enforces rules defined in functional requirements and use cases. FalconScan has several critical business rules, such as classifying vulnerabilities by severity, prioritizing high-risk APKs, and restricting access based on roles. Decision table testing was applied to validate these rules systematically.

Decision Table for Severity Classification

Table 5.8: Severity classification

Condition	Permission Misuse	Dangerous API	Network Risk	Action
C1	Yes	Yes	Yes	High Severity
C2	Yes	No	Yes	Medium Severity
C3	No	Yes	No	Medium Severity
C4	No	No	No	Low Severity

Decision-based testing verifies that input conditions produce the correct severity classification and ensure the AI reasoning outputs are consistent with these rules. All combinations of conditions were tested using automated scripts to ensure that rules were enforced correctly.

5.4 Integration Testing

Integration testing validates that FalconScan modules work together seamlessly. This includes the interaction between APK upload, static analysis, dynamic analysis, fuzzing, AI reasoning engine, and report generation. Integration testing ensures data flow consistency, correct API interactions, and accurate AI predictions in combination with other modules.

Integration Testing Objective:

1. Verify that APK uploads trigger all analysis modules.
2. Confirm that static, dynamic, and fuzzing results are combined and passed to the AI engine.
3. Ensure that AI outputs are correctly stored and displayed in reports.
4. Validate notification and logging interfaces between modules.

Integration Testing: Complete Scan Workflow

Table 5.9: Integration Testing 1 - Scan Workflow

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result	Result
1	Upload APK → Static Analysis → Dynamic Analysis → AI	APK file: TestApp_v1.apk	Vulnerabilities detected by all modules, AI classifies correctly, report generated	Workflow completed successfully	Pass
2	Trigger Fuzzing module → AI input	APK file: TestApp_v2.apk	Fuzzing anomalies processed by AI, severity assigned, included in report	Pass	Pass

Integration Testing: User Notification and Report Linking

Table 5.10: Integration Testing 2 - Notification and Report Linking

No.	Test Case/Test Script	Attribute and Value	Expected Result	Actual Result	Result
1	Update AI classification → Notify User	Scan complete, severity high	User receives email notification, report linked in dashboard	Notification sent, report linked correctly	Pass
2	Rescan APK → Update Historical Report	APK file previously scanned	Historical data updated with new results	Updated successfully	Pass

Integration testing ensured that the individual modules, when combined, provide a fully functional system where data, AI outputs, and user notifications interact without errors or data loss.

In conclusion, Chapter 5 demonstrates that FalconScan underwent rigorous testing at multiple levels. Unit testing validated individual functions and preprocessing routines. Functional testing confirmed user-facing features and system modules perform as expected. Business rules testing ensured all severity classifications and security logic were consistently applied. Integration

testing demonstrated seamless module interoperability, accurate AI predictions, and correct data handling throughout the end-to-end workflow. Testing confirmed that FalconScan is reliable, secure, and ready for deployment.

6 Chapter 6: Conclusion and Future Work

This chapter provides a comprehensive conclusion of the FalconScan project, summarizing its achievements and reflecting on the objectives established in the early chapters. Additionally, it outlines future work and enhancements that can be incorporated in upcoming submissions or iterations. Since this submission represents the initial 30% of the full project, the focus has been on implementing the front-end, back-end, and static analysis modules. The dynamic analysis, AI preprocessing, and advanced features will be developed in future phases.

6.1 Conclusion

The primary objective of FalconScan is to provide a comprehensive APK vulnerability scanning system capable of analyzing Android applications for potential security threats, misconfigurations, and privacy risks. The project aims to automate the process of static and dynamic analysis while providing an intuitive interface for users and administrators to monitor scan results efficiently.

In the current 30% implementation, the system successfully addresses several key goals. The front-end, developed using Next.js, provides a responsive and organized interface that allows users to register, login, upload APKs, and view scan results. Features such as role-based login, dashboards, and user profile management have been integrated, ensuring that both normal users and administrative users can navigate the system effectively.

The back-end, built on Django REST Framework, establishes the foundational infrastructure required for managing user data, APK uploads, scans, and reports. Critical functionalities such as user authentication, authorization, API endpoints for file upload and report retrieval, and database management are fully operational. JWT authentication ensures secure access, and proper API structure allows future integration of additional modules such as AI-assisted analysis and dynamic scanning.

The static analysis module is currently the most significant functional feature of FalconScan. Using tools like APKTool and JADX, the system can decompile APKs, extract the

AndroidManifest.xml, analyze permissions, exported components, and network configurations. Python-based scanners detect code patterns that may indicate vulnerabilities, such as hardcoded credentials, insecure cryptography, exposed WebView interfaces, and unsafe HTTP usage. These analyses produce structured, human-readable results that can be used for immediate reporting and risk assessment.

While the initial implementation demonstrates substantial progress, certain limitations exist. Dynamic analysis, fuzzing, AI-based preprocessing, and advanced vulnerability reasoning have not yet been implemented. As such, the current system is limited to static scanning capabilities. Additionally, deployment is currently on a local machine, which restricts multi-user access and scalability. Despite these limitations, the system provides a strong foundation for vulnerability analysis and establishes a functional workflow from APK upload to reporting.

Overall, FalconScan significantly improves the efficiency and accuracy of Android application security analysis for users and administrators. The system automates time-consuming manual review processes, ensures structured reporting of vulnerabilities, and provides an intuitive interface for monitoring and managing scan results. It demonstrates that even with partial functionality, the objectives of simplifying security assessment and improving risk visibility can be achieved effectively.

6.2 Future Work

FalconScan has been designed with modularity and scalability in mind, allowing future development to extend the system's capabilities substantially. Future work will focus on implementing modules that enhance automation, intelligence, and usability.

1. **Dynamic Analysis Module**

   The next phase of development will introduce dynamic analysis capabilities. Using an Android emulator environment, the system will monitor runtime behavior, API calls, file system interactions, and network traffic. This will allow detection of vulnerabilities that

are only observable during execution, such as unauthorized network access, runtime code loading, or misuse of system APIs.

2. **AI-Based Preprocessing and Analysis**

   Once dynamic data is available, AI models such as LLMs will be incorporated to analyze behavioral patterns and classify vulnerabilities intelligently. Preprocessing steps will structure dynamic logs, runtime events, and crash reports into interpretable formats for machine learning or deep learning models. AI reasoning will provide severity scoring, confidence metrics, and developer-friendly remediation suggestions.

3. **Advanced Reporting and Analytics**

   Future iterations will include dashboards with visual analytics, risk heatmaps, and interactive reports. Users will be able to filter, sort, and prioritize vulnerabilities based on severity, affected components, and exploitability. Integration with CVSS scoring and automated mitigation suggestions will further enhance decision-making.

4. **UI/UX Improvements**

   Based on initial user feedback and usability tests, the interface will be refined. This includes improved navigation, real-time status updates during scans, progress indicators, and mobile-friendly responsiveness. A notification system for scan completions and alerts will also be implemented.

5. **Scalability and Deployment**

   The system will transition from a local host deployment to cloud or server-based deployment, allowing multiple users to access FalconScan concurrently. This will support load balancing, secure file storage, and automated backups. Multi-branch or multi-instance deployment strategies can also be considered for enterprise-level adoption.

6. **Integration with External Systems**

Future work may include integration with external systems such as ERP platforms, CI/CD pipelines, or IoT devices. This will allow automated scanning of applications before release, improving overall software security hygiene.

7. **Automation and Predictive Analysis**

   Machine learning techniques can be used to predict potential vulnerabilities in newly uploaded APKs based on historical trends, usage patterns, and known attack signatures. Automation will reduce human intervention and speed up the analysis pipeline.

8. **Enhanced Security and Authentication**

   Although JWT authentication is implemented, future work may incorporate multi-factor authentication, biometric verification, and enhanced encryption for sensitive data, ensuring compliance with evolving cybersecurity standards.

In conclusion, while FalconScan's current implementation covers foundational front-end, back-end, and static analysis modules, the planned enhancements will expand its functionality into a comprehensive, AI-assisted vulnerability scanning system. Future work will enable dynamic analysis, predictive AI reasoning, advanced reporting, scalability, and secure deployment, thereby creating a fully automated and intelligent platform for Android application security. This phased approach ensures that the project can be continuously improved while meeting deadlines for partial submissions.

7 Chapter 7: References

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8 Chapter 8: Plagiarism Report

8% detected as AI

The percentage indicates the combined amount of likely AI-generated text as well as likely AI-generated text that was also likely AI-paraphrased.

Caution: Review required.

It is essential to understand the limitations of AI detection before making decisions about a student's work. We encourage you to learn more about Turnitin's AI detection capabilities before using the tool.

Detection Groups

1 AI-generated only 8%
Likely AI-generated text from a large-language model.

0 AI-generated text that was AI-paraphrased 0%
Likely AI-generated text that was likely revised using an AI-paraphrase tool or word spinner.

Disclaimer
Our AI writing assessment is designed to help educators identify text that might be prepared by a generative AI tool. Our AI writing assessment may not always be accurate (it may misidentify writing that is likely AI generated as AI generated and AI paraphrased or likely AI generated and AI paraphrased writing as only AI generated) so it should not be used as the sole basis for adverse actions against a student. It takes further scrutiny and human judgment in conjunction with an organization's application of its specific academic policies to determine whether any academic misconduct has occurred.

Frequently Asked Questions

How should I interpret Turnitin's AI writing percentage and false positives?
The percentage shown in the AI writing report is the amount of qualifying text within the submission that Turnitin's AI writing detection model determines was either likely AI-generated text from a large-language model or likely AI-generated text that was likely revised using an AI-paraphrase tool or word spinner.



False positives (incorrectly flagging human-written text as AI-generated) are a possibility in AI models.

AI detection scores under 20%, which we do not surface in new reports, have a higher likelihood of false positives. To reduce the likelihood of misinterpretation, no score or highlights are attributed and are indicated with an asterisk in the report (*%).

The AI writing percentage should not be the sole basis to determine whether misconduct has occurred. The reviewer/instructor should use the percentage as a means to start a formative conversation with their student and/or use it to examine the submitted assignment in accordance with their school's policies.

What does 'qualifying text' mean?
Our model only processes qualifying text in the form of long-form writing. Long-form writing means individual sentences contained in paragraphs that make up a longer piece of written work, such as an essay, a dissertation, or an article, etc. Qualifying text that has been determined to be likely AI-generated will be highlighted in cyan in the submission, and likely AI-generated and then likely AI-paraphrased will be highlighted purple.

Non-qualifying text, such as bullet points, annotated bibliographies, etc., will not be processed and can create disparity between the submission highlights and the percentage shown.